

This book addresses questions surrounding the constructions of space, culture, society, identity and representation. The geography of cinema extends beyond the screen, director and audience, to include the wider industrial and political complex of the cultural economy. In this sense, culture can be viewed as an economic commodity set within the broader frame of globalization and postmodernism. A cinematic world occupies a territory

between our city's streets, the Cineplex, the TV set, and our geographical imagination and identity. These contexts invite inquiries into the production, distribution, exhibition, and consumption of film as well as global cinema, hapticalities of viewing, critical political economies, and cinematic ethnographies. This collection provides unique and eclectic insights into the exciting and emerging subfield of film geography.

www.steiner-verlag.de

Franz Steiner Verlag

ISBN 978-3-515-09199-2



9 783515 091992



Geographie

Media Geography – 1

Franz Steiner Verlag

The Geography of Cinema – A Cinematic World

Edited by Chris Lukinbeal
and Stefan Zimmermann

ZC 103,1
3. Ex.

MEDIA GEOGRAPHY AT MAINZ

Edited by

Anton Escher
Chris Lukinbeal
Stefan Zimmermann

Volume I

The Geography of Cinema –
A Cinematic World

Edited by Chris Lukinbeal and Stefan Zimmermann



Franz Steiner Verlag Stuttgart 2008

Geograph. Institut
der Universität Mainz
Inv. Nr. 2014/16

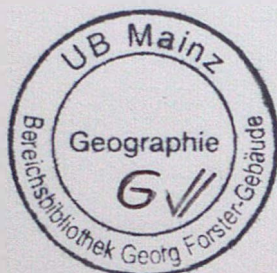
10.12.14

Johannes Gutenberg-Universität Mainz
Fachbereich 09 / Chemie, Pharmazie und
Geowissenschaften

Geographisches Institut
Johann-Joachim-Becher-Weg 21
55099 Mainz

Zc 103,1
3. Ex.

Cover illustration: „The Pope of Broadway“ depicts Anthony Quinn on the Victor Clothing Company Building, 242 South Broadway, Los Angeles, California. Mural by Eloy Torrez, assisted by Bob Grigas, 1985. Photography by Chris Lukinbeal.



Bibliographische Information der Deutschen Bibliothek

Die Deutsche Bibliothek verzeichnet diese Publikation in der Deutschen Nationalbibliographie; detaillierte bibliographische Daten sind im Internet über <<http://dnb.ddb.de>> abrufbar.

ISBN 978-3-515-09199-2

Jede Verwertung des Werkes außerhalb der Grenzen des Urheberrechtsgesetzes ist unzulässig und strafbar. Dies gilt insbesondere für Übersetzung, Nachdruck, Mikroverfilmung oder vergleichbare Verfahren sowie für die Speicherung in Datenverarbeitungsanlagen.

© 2008 Franz Steiner Verlag, Stuttgart
Gedruckt auf säurefreiem, alterungsbeständigem Papier.
Druck: Laupp und Göbel, Nehren
Printed in Germany

Geographers usually see themselves in a tradition of Alexander von Humboldt and we would like to highlight his position that everything in our world is interdependent. Deriving from that assumption geography has to be seen as an unlimited science, a discipline that knows the borders but has none.

Anton Escher, Chris Lukinbeal and Stefan Zimmermann,
Tempe and Mainz, January 2008

CONTENTS

Preface	9
---------------	---

INTRODUCTION

<i>Chris Lukinbeal / Stefan Zimmermann</i> A Cinematic World	15
---	----

<i>Deborah Dixon / Leo Zonn / Johnathan Bascom</i> Post-ing the Cinema: Reassessing Analytical Stances Toward a Geography of Film	25
---	----

THE AUTHOR

<i>Joseph Palis</i> An Unmapped People and Places: Cinema, Nation and the Aesthetics of Affection	51
---	----

<i>Gerd Becker</i> Nouri Bouzid's <i>Bezness</i> as a Visual Study on the Glance: Reflections on Exploring the Scientific Potential of Non-verbal Cinema	59
--	----

<i>Deborah Dixon</i> 'Independent' Documentary in the U.S.: The Politics of Personal Passions	65
---	----

THE TEXT

<i>Marcus A. Doel</i> From Animated Photography to Film: the Formation of Vernacular Relativity in Early English Films (1895-1908)	87
--	----

<i>David B. Clarke</i> Spaces of Anonymity	101
---	-----

<i>Christopher M. Moreno / Stuart Aitken</i> Space Operas and Cultures of Addiction: The Animated Tale of Philip K. Dick's <i>A Scanner Darkly</i>	115
--	-----

Susan P. Mains

'English Fever': Documenting the Caribbean Diaspora in *The Colony* 137

Mita Banerjee / Peter W. Marx

Ally Lives Just Next Door...

German-U.S. Relations in Popular Culture 155

Stefan Zimmermann

Landscapes of *Heimat* in Post-war German Cinema 171

THE READER

Christina Beal Kennedy

Living with Film: An Autobiographical Approach 187

Contributors 205

PREFACE

Most of the essays in this volume derived from an international symposium, *The Geography of Cinema – A Cinematic World*, at the Institute of Geography at the Johannes Gutenberg-University Mainz in June 2004. While special sessions on cinema and the media have occurred at conferences in Europe, the UK, the U.S. and Australia, this symposium was the first to gather some of the leading scholars in cinematic geography from around the world. The objective of the symposium was to explore the burgeoning subfield of film geography and chart new research trajectories (Figure 1). We, the organizers, also sought to close the gap between film studies and geography while broadening the existing knowledge base of both.

A highlight of the symposium included the showing of documentary films at Caligari FilmBühne in Wiesbaden¹ produced by faculty and students at the Institute of Geography at Johannes Gutenberg-University in Mainz. Also shown at the theatre was Susan Main's preliminary work on documenting diaspora and stories of Jamaican migration to the UK. Rather than just presentations on current research and group discussions, this event encouraged geographers to engage film production, digital media and documentary filmmaking. This event was the impetus for later documentary projects in Arizona² and at San Diego and Northridge, California³.

We are grateful that nearly all of the sixteen scholars invited were able to attend and present their latest research. Scholars came from Germany, the United Kingdom, United States, Jamaica and the Philippines. We are indebted to the Centre for Intercultural Studies⁴ of the Johannes Gutenberg-University Mainz, who deemed this event worthy of financial support. Some of the essays from the symposium were published in *Erdkunde* (2006, volume 60, number 4; see Figure 2) and other essays were requested from authors who were at the symposium for

1. <http://www.wiesbaden.de/caligari>, a historical neo-Gothic style theater that opened in 1926.
2. The *Mediated Geographies: Critical Pedagogy and Geographic Education* project produced a series of student based documentary, all of which are located on the project website: <http://geography.asu.edu/lukinbeal/mediated.html>. One of Ari PALOS' documentaries (the project's consultant) is discussed in this book in Deborah Dixon's chapter on independent U.S. documentary films.
3. These projects were presented at the 2007 annual meeting of the Association of Pacific Coast Geographers (<http://www.csus.edu/apcg/>). Some of these documentaries will be a part of an upcoming special issue of *Aether: The Journal of Media Geography*. *Aether: The Journal of Media Geography* is a new online journal that started publishing in the fall of 2007. Many of the participants from this symposium are on its editorial board and have written essays for its first volume. For more information see: www.aetherjournal.org
4. Zentrum für Interkulturelle Studien (ZIS)

Figure 1. Programme The Geography of Cinema – A Cinematic World

Symposium: <i>The Geography of Cinema – A Cinematic World</i> 24. – 26. June 2004 Chair: Alfred Hornung und Anton Escher	
<u>Thursday 24th June, Institute of Geography</u> Deborah Dixon / Stuart Aitken: The Geography of Cinema Marcus Doel: "Animated photography and vernacular relativity: engineering space and time in early English films" Deborah Dixon: Framing Border Landscapes Mita Banerjee & Peter W. Marx: "Ally lives just next door..." German-US-American relations in popular culture. Christina Kennedy: Place, Emotion and Experience: an Autobiographical Approach to the "Reel"	
<u>Friday 25th June, Caligari FilmBühne (Wiesbaden)</u> Bernd Kiefer: The Caligari: a place of visual pleasure Susan Mains: Translating Mobility: Documenting Diaspora and Storics of Jamaican Migration Helge Weichmann: Geographic Fieldwork in Film – Marrakech Wolfgang Natter: Place and Space in Community-based filmmaking: The Geographies of Appalshop (Kentucky) Stephanie Schimo: Nare – A Life between saucepan and notebook Joseph S.E. Palis: Mapping the Heart of Brazil in Walter Salles "Central Station"	
<u>Saturday 26th June, Institute of Geography</u> Gerd Becker: <i>Nouri Bouzid's</i> Film <i>Bezness</i> as a visual study on the gaze Stuart Aitken: Leading Men to Violence and Creating Spaces for their Emotions Dave Clarke: Moving pictures / stopping places: hotels and motels on film Christopher Lukinbeal: "Runaway Hollywood" Stefan Zimmermann: Landscapes of "Heimat" in post-war German cinema Final discussion	

Figure 2. Essays deriving from the Symposium which have been published in *Erdkunde*

AITKEN, S. and DIXON, D. 2006: Imagining Geographies of Film. In: <i>Erdkunde</i> 60 (4), 326–336. ESCHER, A. 2006: The Geography of Cinema. A Cinematic World. In: <i>Erdkunde</i> 60 (4), 307–314. LUKINBEAL, C. 2006: Runaway Hollywood. Cold Mountain, Romania. In: <i>Erdkunde</i> 60 (4), 337–345. LUKINBEAL, C. and ZIMMERMANN, S. 2006: Film Geography. A New Subfield. In: <i>Erdkunde</i> 60 (4), 315–325.
--

inclusion in this book. Also, one essay from the symposium has since been published in *Gender, Place and Culture* (Stuart AITKEN 2006, "Leading Men to Violence and Creating Spaces for their Emotions," 13, 492–507). The essays by David Clarke and Marcus Doel represent larger projects that have gone on to engage hotels and motels in film and the transition of animated photography into film. Rather than a compressive compendium that seeks to sum up the totality of a new subfield, this book aims to foster further interest and dialogue about geographic research on cinema.

This book represents the first of a new series to be offered by Franz Steiner Verlag. The series, "Media Geography at Mainz", will be edited by Anton Escher, Chris Lukinbeal and Stefan Zimmermann. Two future volumes are already in the works including, Gerd Becker's "Eying the Globe – Science and Visuality" and Stefan Zimmermann's "Deserts, Palm Trees and Bazaars – The Cinematic Geography of the Orient". All books will be published in English and we welcome inquiries related to possible book length manuscripts related to media geography.

We deeply appreciate the editing and editorial comments that Tina Kennedy and Kathrin Samstag made on the penultimate draft of this book.

Chris Lukinbeal, Anton Escher & Stefan Zimmermann,
 Tempe and Mainz, August 2008

Chris Lukinbeal / Stefan Zimmermann

A CINEMATIC WORLD

*With cinema, it is the world
which becomes its own image, and
not an image which becomes the world*

(DELEUZE 1986, 57).

INTRODUCTION

Gillian ROSE (2003) recently asked the question, "how, exactly, is Geography 'visual'?" The assumption is that, if we are a visual discipline, we already understand 'the visual.' The use of visuals abound in geographic practice whether in research, remote sensing, GIS, animated maps, photographs, film and television, or charts and graphs. In our teaching, visuals are so commonplace in lectures and presentations that it seems odd to witness a pedagogic event without them. Whether through the use of PowerPoint, slides, the Internet or documentaries and feature films, the visual dominates our educational practices. Many geographers assert that the ocularcentrism of geography is a primary *modus operandi* towards geographical knowledge. But how does the visual structure geographical knowledge? ROSE (2003, 2001) asserts that *visuality* refers to what we see, how we see, and what we are able to see. *Visuality* is of particular importance because power relations always saturate it. This is not to say that geography has not questioned the visual, or *visuality*; quite the contrary. Much work has been done on *visuality* as it relates to the construction and depiction of social difference, power relations, subjectivity and identity formation, as well as how it impacts the body. Decoding hierarchies, exposing practices of inclusion and exclusion, and revealing how *visuality* naturalizes ideologies and our view of the 'other,' remain active arenas of geographic inquiry.

We suggest that much geographic research on film has focused on the content of the visual, or what is seen and unseen (cf. DOEL and CLARKE 2007). While this is a very important aspect of querying exactly how geography is visual, it does not fully address all the modalities of film geography. In this introduction, then, we wish to explore aspects of geographic *visuality* as they relate to film geography. We assert that a pure focus on *visuality* limits the purview of film geography. Film is an assemblage of sight and sound, of texture and (e)motion, memory and experience. Moving beyond the sensory subjectivities of voyeurism and voyages, film is, paradoxically, also an assemblage of simulacra and of representational, non-

representational, haptical, affective and performative practices. While other assemblages and modalities of exploring film geography are found throughout this book and elsewhere, our aim here is to develop a dialogue that embraces new opportunities for inquiry into cinematic geographies; while, at the same time, not jettisoning traditional cultural geographic theories and practices that provide foundational frameworks.

In this introductory essay, we address ROSE's challenge by discussing three aspects of the visual in the world of cinematic geography. These aspects include the content of what is seen, the form of seeing and the affect of what is seen.

WHAT IS SEEN – THE CONTENT

Authors in this collection use different theoretical approaches when addressing the content of what is seen in film. These approaches range from humanistic, positivistic, and text-centered, to poststructural and psychoanalytic.

The chapter by DIXON, ZONN and BASCOM provides an overview of different approaches that have been used to analyze the content of film by elaborating on an organizational framework of author-centered, text-centered, and reader-centered approaches. Rather than dismissing structural theories that underlie much of the initial inquiries into film geography, their aim is to illustrate how structural and poststructural theories illustrate larger ontological and epistemological debates that challenge how the visual constructs geographic knowledge. Where humanistic inquiry seeks to expose the emotional force and fabric of textual-subject relations between place, film, and viewer (as in Tina KENNEDY's chapter), BECKER's chapter uses a positivistic perspective to counter the dominance of the written word in documenting ethnographies; thereby, allowing researchers to learn from feature films how to tell more accurate and effective visual stories of cultures in place. Marxist and neo-Marxist inquiries work to expose dominate ideologies (that are naturalized within documentaries, feature films and television shows) and to articulate counter hegemonic narratives that seek to resist and subvert established 'ways of seeing.' These approaches are seen in DIXON's chapter on Independent U.S. Documentary Films, and, to a lesser extent, in Joseph PALIS's chapter.

Drawing from poststructural inquiry, BANERJEE and MARX's chapter, as well as MAINS' chapter explore how film and television articulate the 'other' and how race and ethnicity are contested and negotiated identities in a globalized era of transcontinental flows of people and cultures. Both chapters show how film and television work to 'fix' identities and reinforce cultural norms of inclusion and exclusion, promoting marginalized mediated spaces in which ethnic identities are reified as the 'other' to mainstream homogenous inclusive myths. However, as BANERJEE and MARX, as well as MAINS, explain, subterranean and overt challenges to mythic media representations show that identity is relational and constantly under negotiation. In his chapter, ZIMMERMANN shows how films from a particular genre, *Heimat*, played a key role in the transition of Germany national identity during post World War II. *Heimat* films worked to provide a national identity, founded on

traditional cultural values that allowed Germans to take pride in their heritage, and, at the same time, helped heal the wounds of the recent destruction of their cities. Through a return to the rural idyllic, folklore, and sentimental bonds with landscape, the Heimat genre reveals how the affective power of film can move beyond the individual to the cultural.

Drawing from psychoanalysis and poststructural theories, CLARKE's chapter, as well as that of MORENO and AITKEN, challenges the social-spatial dialectic and moves beyond, within and outside the fixed scalar boundaries of body, individual, society and culture. Non-representational, unconscious spaces are not fixed within the scale of the mind or body; rather, movement, action, reaction and behavior flow freely across scales. CLARKE suggests that hotels, as non-places or resting points where the accelerated circulation of global flows stop to recharge, provide for chance encounters that produce a unique type of subjectivity, an inconsequential togetherness, an anti-church of sorts. MORENO and AITKEN further challenge us to rethink how film, space, and the scales of the body move freely because of addiction. Thereby, this fluidity produces new geographic configurations that we previously may not have considered.

A focus on the content of what is seen configures film as social texts, objects worthy of geographic inquiry. Whatever form social texts take, their symbolic qualities inform, challenge and negotiate social-spatial meaning. In their book, *Engaging Film*, CRESSWELL and DIXON (2002) argue that the textual metaphor has become hegemonic within film geography primarily because it is a powerful and appropriate means through which to engage cultural and social politics of meaning (re)production.

'Text' refers to a signifying practice associated with types of cultural production including the written word, painting, landscape and film. Textual analysis is a hermeneutical method focused on assumption and inquiry, where we query a 'text' guided by a hypothesis. The creative interaction, or hermeneutical circle of going back-and-forth between the interpreter's theoretical framework and the text being studied, leads to meaning and understanding. Diffusion of this hermeneutical method to geography followed the "linguistic turn" in the social sciences.

Applying the notion of 'text' to other forms of cultural production assumes that they are metaphorically like texts. This leads to two different questions: First, is 'text' a good paradigm for film geography? Second, how is the textual metaphor overlaid onto the content of what is seen? Extrapolating from RICOEUR's (1971) work, the textual metaphor is a valid means of inquiry for four reasons. First, written discourse and social life have similar characteristics. As such, meaning is constructed through the act of writing just as agency reifies the built environment (cf. COSGROVE 1984). Second, intention and reception of any text often fail to coincide. Similarly, actions can become detached from agents and can have effects beyond the scale of their intent. This can happen for both the 'text' under inquiry and the 'text' being constructed (cf. DUNCAN and DUNCAN 1988). Third, interpretation of texts and cultural events vary with location, culture and era. In other words, the ethical issue of essentialism, where one's views speak for others,

remains a fundamental issue regardless of whether the item being studied is a text, event, or action (SMITH 2002). Fourth, textual meaning is unstable and fluid because it is interpreted. Similarly, social institutions and actions are also unstable and fluid because meaning is constituted through the relative position of the interpreter. Relativism, or the fact that interpretation is relative to the interpreter, is an issue regardless of the method of inquiry. ROSE (2001) takes this a step further when suggesting that discourse analysis can take two forms: the first focuses on the contested meanings within a text (the text-centered approach). The second examines the articulation of discourse in social practices, institutions and technologies that produce texts (the author-centered approach). DIXON, ZONN and BASCOM offer a third, reader-centered, approach. Here, rather than dismissing the issue of relativism, they argue that this approach empowers the reader-viewer by granting them the authority to appropriate, resist or transform the meanings within social texts. This exposes the fact that relativism is not about coming to a consensus about one 'true' meaning or understanding; rather, it is a discursive process wherein negotiation of social meanings are conceived as heterogeneous rather than homogenous. The textual metaphor, overlaid onto the content of what is seen, is paradigmatic because it is a method rather than a theory. Readings can be from a diversity of theoretical positions allowing film geography to develop a truly discursive environment in which to prosper.

The textual metaphor, however, has its limits. For example, an alternative model of inquiry into film geography may follow a production-product-distribution-consumption model in which the text is primarily, but not wholly, constituted by the product. This alternative model of inquiry centers on film as part of a cultural economy that produces cultural goods for global consumption. According to SCOTT (2005, 3), "the cultural economy can be broadly defined as a group of sectors ... that produce goods and services whose subjective meaning, or, more precisely sign-value to the consumer is high in comparison with their utilitarian purpose." Under this rubric, the cinematic world is mutually constitutive of social texts and extra-textual processes. In their examination of the global dominance of the Hollywood film industry, MILLER et al. (2005, 5) argue, "unlike textual reductionists, we do not assume that it is adequate to interpret a film's internal qualities or the supposed 'positioning' of mythic spectators." DIXON's chapter, on independent documentary films in the U.S., presents an author-centered textual analysis in which extra-textual processes, concerning the role of state funding of documentary films, are explored. She argues that the state, through funding, defines documentaries and reifies the idealized notion of rural spaces by focusing on hard-working individuals. As such, society is positioned within President Johnson's notion of a Great Society that frames marginalization within a neoliberal discourse.

While methodological in nature, the textual metaphor may reinforce specific epistemological and ontological formations. CRESSWELL and DIXON (2002) argue that a focus on text and context within the textual metaphor resembles, and may even reinforce, the normative belief that film is a re-presentation of reality. By connecting film with representation, a binary is constructed wherein the 'reel' is a

second-hand experience and the 'real' is a primary experience. This binary reinforces the belief that film is of secondary importance to direct geographic studies in the field. This binary further reinforces a hegemonic order within geography, delimiting what is an acceptable and unacceptable mode of inquiry. Only recently has film geography begun to overcome this arbitrary normative belief. LUKINBEAL and ZIMMERMANN (2006, 322) challenge the deterministic logic of the binary stating:

We eschew the representational determinism that film geography is synonymous with *re*-presentations of some ontological stable "authentic" reality. Drawing from CRANG et al. (1999, 2), we posit that film geography always exceeds the cinematic technologies which produce representations because film is "constituted by the social relations, discourses and sites in which these technologies are embedded." The technologies that capture, encode and represent the world are always embedded in social and cultural practices that are temporally and spatially specific. Representations are not the polar opposite of reality especially when it comes to film and cinema. Cinematic images are always socialized just as technologies are always socialized.

CLARKE (1997) succinctly argues that cinema is simulacral rather than representational. CRESSWELL and DIXON (2002, 3-4) contend that films are not "mere images of unmediated expressions of the mind, but rather the temporary embodiment of social processes that continually construct and deconstruct the world as we know it." LUKINBEAL (2004, 247) expounds upon this idea stating, "visual media are today's cognitive maps (JAMESON 1984, 1988, 1992) or social cartography (BRUNO 1997, 2002) of meaning creation and identity formation." Therefore, the simulacrum does not conceal truth; truth conceals that there is none (BAUDRILLARD 1988). This leads us to back to our opening quotation by DELEUZE (1986, 57) which explains that the world is not imaged, imagined or re-presented by cinema, but rather the world becomes its own image, "a real without origin or reality: a hyperreal" (BAUDRILLARD 1983, 2). Querying cinema as simulacra leads us away from the content of what is seen and begins to questioning the form of the seen.

THE FORM OF WHAT IS SEEN

Cinema makes no claims that it is anything but a mechanical re-production. Rather than re-producing the 'real' or re-producing what is 'seen', cinema produces a 'reality-effect' – a simulacrum of the real. Cinema is a machine for constructing different relations between space and time. What is seen in a landscape amounts to a representational form that affords the subject apparent mastery over space by aligning vision with truth. In this sense 'seeing is believing' and the 'seen' is a fixed, centered, and all embarrassing gaze. Seeing is not objective; rather, it is a practiced appropriation of space constituted through learned 'ways of seeing,' or scopic regimes ingrained by social and cultural norms. Scopic regime, a term coined by Christian METZ (1977), seeks to differentiate 'vision' from 'visuality.' Whereas 'vision' is often considered a universal and natural, subject-centered phenomenon, 'visuality' emphasizes that ways of looking are not natural; rather, they are socially constructed. Further, scopic regimes have a history wherein specific regimes become hegemonic during specific cultural eras. Both ZIMMERMANN's and DOEL's

chapters, for instance, focus on the synchronic nature of scopic regimes within German culture (ZIMMERMANN) and the form of film itself (DOEL).

DOEL argues that there is a significant omission within film geography on the study of the form of film itself. While much has been written on the content, or function of film, form has its own spatial and temporal characteristics that are distinct from, yet related to, function. Focusing on the formative years of film, DOEL traces the geographies of film's scopic regime as it transitioned from animated photography into narrative cinema. Under the scopic regime of animated photography, public interest was tautological in that audiences wanted ultra-realism, life-like animation, or re-presentations of actual life. During this period, film sought to re-produce true movement – to *animate* photography. Misrepresentation of natural movement produced negative reviews from trade journals. Film was evaluated on its ability to re-present motion. Because of this, film was sold by the foot with purchasers showing concern about paying for any footage that was not truly animated. DOEL argues that, with continuity editing and narrative space decades away, time was inscribed “synchronically within the scene, rather than being fashioned diachronically between scenes through editing” (DOEL, current volume). The shift in film's scopic regime occurred when cinema stopped “re-presenting an actual or staged instant” and started to function “as an apparatus that could both manipulate and manufacture space and time. In so doing, animated photography ceased being a *referential* medium, bound to the *Real*, to become a simulacral medium, free to fabricate a reality-effect” (DOEL, current volume). Film ceased functioning as representational (imaging the world) and became simulacral (a world becomes its own image). The essential element of film, then, “is not the framed image” or the content “but that which comes *between* the frames: *the cut*” (DOEL, current volume).

With animated photography, the focus is on the seen on the visual and representational. With narrative cinema, the focus shifts to the scene, visuality and simulacra through use of montage. HEATH (1981) argues that classic narrative space provides a solution to coordinating the problem of space and time relations in film. Classic narrative space became the dominant scopic regime of film which sought to mend the tension between quattrocento space (a central, fixed all embracing point of view) and the inherent movement of film which threatened the fixity of the gaze. He refers to the practice devised to convert ‘seen’ (fixed) into ‘scene’ (mobilized) via a manner which “contains the mobility that could threaten the clarity of vision” (HEATH 1981, 36) by constantly re-centering the observer's point of view. CLARKE's and DOEL's (CLARKE and DOEL 2005, 2006, 2007; DOEL and CLARKE 2007) excellent work on the transition within film's scopic regime shows that initially viewers were uncomfortable with point-of-view shots and continuity editing and found them ‘unnatural.’ Over time, however, this new visuality was naturalized and a new scopic regime accepted.

THE AFFECT OF WHAT IS SEEN

Ari PALOS, a documentary filmmaker (cited in DIXON's chapter), commented that film is not simply visual, but, rather, an assemblage of both the audio and visual (cf. LUKINBEAL et al. 2007). Where others have focused on the affective visual nature of film (AITKEN 2006; CARTER and MCCORMACK 2006), we argue that audio is equally essential to affect in film. Audio guides affective response. It saturates film and sutures the 'seen' into the 'scene'; gives space depth through emotive becoming, and guides the unconscious experiential musings of the mind – turning the voyeur into a voyager of spaces seen and unseen. It calls on our subjectivity to react to seen, heard, felt, and experienced memories and emotions. The assemblage of audio-video takes us on a voyage through ourselves as much as through the film's narrative. This voyage positions us in a dialectics of cinema's 'reality-effect' and our affective relation to our own reality. Music, within film, often produces and guides affective response. Imagine the different effects and affect of blending peaceful, contemplative classical music with the camera's movement through a pastoral rolling hills landscape, to combining heavy metal, pulsating, music with a car chase; or gothic music with a dark, seedy urban landscape. Furthermore, music and the visual assembled in unexpected ways can lead to startling affective responses. Quentin TARANTINO's films, for instance, frequently juxtapose songs from popular culture with violence thus producing strange, divergent, affective spaces. Music also can be central to montage, producing emotionally laden reality effects wherein the syncopation of the music effectively sutures the visual into an affective scene.

A focus on the affect of what is seen *and* heard is not about untangling the emotive from meaning or the subjective from objective; rather, it is about how affect leads us to certain responses. This focus takes us down certain logical pathways that lead us to structure what the author, text, or reader's role is in relation to what the film means to us rationally; while, simultaneously, exploring how affect functions unconsciously on subjectivity, self identity and social identity. Affect works through and beyond us – producing responses at larger scales, or across networks – as our affect affects others. A film's affect provokes tension, contestation, and emotional responses because it does not separate subject (the viewer) from object (the content and form of the visual / audio). Cinema, therefore, is a haptical mobilization, an (e)motional journey that leads us to questions our identity and its relation to values, experiences, and knowledge (BRUNO 2002). Affect moves beyond reflect(ion) to engage the content and form of the visual, as well as our own subjectivity, beyond the reality-effect that film affords. According to CARTER and MCCORMACK (2006, 236), film's affect moves beyond an individual's relative interpretation because it is a "matter of the production and circulation of affects prior to yet also providing the grounds from which distinctive intensities of feeling emerge." While the focus on film geography has been on the representational analytics that "rehearse or disrupt particular discursive codes and scripts" it also "involves a consideration of how they amplify the passage and transition between affect and emotion" (CARTER and MCCORMACK 2006, 236).

In her reader-centered approach to film, KENNEDY's chapter engages film's affective nature through an autobiographical analysis of the role that film played in the formative, childhood years of her life. By positioning herself relationally, rather than objectively, with cinema; KENNEDY is able to explore how affect produces a series of geographies that interconnect her life in film, with film, and because of film.

CONCLUSIONS

Through focusing on three modalities of the visual, we seek to show how film geography is an expanding field of study that moves past re-presentational praxis. Where a focus on the content of what is seen challenges us to probe the relation between visibility and the production of geographical knowledge, a focus on the form of the seen investigates how visualities produce and institute scopic regimes. In focusing on the affect of what is seen, we move within, through, and outside form and content to engage the interdependent nature of film, self, and society. By examining cinema's form, content and affect, we also move beyond representation into simulacra, transcend fixed scales of inquiry, and open dialogues that challenge naturalized scopic regimes, ideologies, myths and truth. Where the visual sees the world of cinema, visibility opens us to a cinematic world.

REFERENCES

- AITKEN, S. (2006): Leading Men to Violence and Creating Spaces for their Emotions. *Gender, Place and Culture* 13 (5), 491–507.
- BAUDRILLARD, J. (1988): *Baudrillard, Selected Writings*, ed. Mark Poster. Stanford.
- BAUDRILLARD, J. (1983): *Simulations*. New York.
- BRUNO, G. (1997): Site-seeing: Architecture and the Moving Image. *Wide Angle* 19 (4), 8–24.
- BRUNO, G. (2002): *The Atlas of Emotion: Journeys in Art, Architecture, and Film*. New York.
- CARTER, S., and D. MCCORMACK (2006): Film, Geopolitics and the affective logics of intervention. *Political Geography* 25, 228–245.
- CLARKE, D., and M. DOEL (2005): Engineering space and time: moving pictures and motionless trips'. *Journal of Historical Geography* 31, 41–60.
- CLARKE, D. (Ed.) (1997): *The Cinematic City*. New York.
- CLARKE, D. and M. DOEL (2007): Shooting space, tracking time: the city from animated photography to vernacular relativity. *Cultural Geographies* 14 (4), 589–609.
- CLARKE, D., and M. DOEL (2006): From Flatlands to Vernacular Relativity: The Genesis of Early English Screenscapes. LEFEBVRE, M. (Ed.): *Landscape and Film*. New York, 213–243.
- COSGROVE, D. (1984): *Social Formations and Symbolic Landscapes*. Totawa, N.J..
- CRANG, M., P. CRANG and J. MAY (1999): Introduction. CRANG, M., P. CRANG and J. MAY (Eds.): *Virtual Geographies: Bodies, space and relations*. London, 1–20.
- CRESSWELL, T., and D. DIXON (2002): Introduction: Engaging Film. CRESSWELL, T. and D. DIXON (Eds.): *Engaging Film: Geographies of Mobility and Identity*. Lanham, Maryland, 1–12.
- DELEUZE, G. (1986): *Cinema 1: The Movement-Image*. London.
- DOEL, M. and D. CLARKE (2007): Afterimages. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 25, 890–910.
- DUNCAN, J. and N. DUNCAN (1988): (Re)reading the landscape. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 6, 117–126.

- HEATH, S. (1981): *Questions of Cinema*. London.
- JAMESON, F. (1984): Postmodernism, or The Logic of Late Capitalism. *New Leftist Review* 146, 53–92.
- JAMESON, F. (1988): Cognitive Mapping. NELSON, C. and L. GROSSBERG (Eds.): *Marxism and the Interpretation of Culture*. Urbana, Illinois, 347–357.
- JAMESON, F. (1992): *The Geopolitical Aesthetic: Cinema and Space in the World System*. Bloomington.
- LUKINBEAL, C. and S. ZIMMERMANN (2006): Film Geography: A New Subfield. *Erdkunde* 60 (4), 315–325.
- LUKINBEAL, C. (2004): The Map That Precedes The Territory: An Introduction To Essays In Cinematic Geography. *GeoJournal* 59 (4), 247–251.
- LUKINBEAL, C., C. KENNEDY, J.P. JONES, J. FINN, K. WOODWARD, D. NELSON, Z. GRANT, N. ANTONOPOLIS, A. PALOS and C. ATKINSON-PALOMBO (2007): Mediated Geographies: Critical Pedagogy and Geographic Education. *Yearbook of the Association of Pacific Coast Geographers* 69, 31–44.
- LUKINBEAL, C. (2004): The Rise of Regional Film Production Centers in North America, 1984–1997. *GeoJournal* 59 (4), 307–321.
- METZ, C. (1977): *The Imaginary Signifier: Psychoanalysis and the Cinema*. Bloomington.
- MILLER, T., N. COVIL, J. MCMURRIA, R. MAXWELL and T. WANG (2005): *Global Hollywood 2*. London.
- RICOEUR, P. (1971): The model of the text. *Social Research* 38: 529–562.
- ROSE, G. (2001): *Visual Methodologies: An Introduction to the Interpretation of Visual Materials*. London.
- ROSE, G. (2003): On the Need to Ask How Exactly, Is Geography “Visual”? *Antipode* 35 (2), 212–221.
- SCOTT, A. (2005): *On Hollywood: The Place, the Industry*. Princeton.
- SMITH, L. (2002): Chips off the Old Ice Block: *Nanook of the North* and the Relocation of Cultural Identity. CRESSWELL, T. and D. DIXON (Eds.): *Engaging Film: Geographies of Mobility and Identity*. Lanham, Maryland, 94–122.

Deborah Dixon / Leo Zonn / Johnathan Bascom

POST-ING THE CINEMA: REASSESSING ANALYTICAL STANCES TOWARD A GEOGRAPHY OF FILM

INTRODUCTION: FILM AS SOCIAL TEXT

The geographic literature on the significance of film, as a mode of social discourse and the utility of film research to academia, has undergone substantial change in recent years. Invigorated by recent theoretical debates on the character of 'representation' from within and beyond the discipline, this sub-field is now considered an appropriate arena within which more general concerns over the relationship between the imagined and the material – the 'reel' and the 'real' – can be given concrete form (DOEL 1993; AITKEN and ZONN 1994; NATTER 1994; DIXON and JONES 1996; DOEL and CLARKE 1996; HANNA 1996). The explicitly pedagogical essays that constituted geography's engagement with film a few decades ago (for example, MANVELL 1956, and WRIGHT 1956, on the use of film as a teaching tool) have been displaced by a proliferation of geographic analyses that take as their focus of inquiry the role of film in: 1) the imposition of dominant ideologies (GOLD 1985; AITKEN 1991, 1993; BOWDEN 1994; HOPKINS 1994; KRIM 1994); 2) the articulation of moments of resistance (NATTER and JONES 1993; ROSE 1994); 3) the production and consumption of intersubjective meanings (ZONN 1984; ZONN and AITKEN 1994); and 4) the negotiation of identities (AITKEN and ZONN 1993, 1994). Within this broad reconceptualization, films are no longer considered an expression of the mind, but rather as constituted within, and therefore the embodiment of, a social totality: they are *social* texts. To put this in more process-orientated terms, it has become axiomatic that films are the product of, and in turn reproductive of, broader social relations of power.

In this paper we explore the axiomatic character of this reconceptualization of film as a social text, noting the shift that has occurred in regard to the perceived theoretical status of film, but we also study some of the often overlooked ramifications of this shift. In particular, we focus on the various ways in which geography's current engagements with film rely, in large part, upon diverse forms of structuralism – an ontological presumption embedded even within those approaches considered most 'postmodern'. In doing so, our intention is not to summarily dismiss such engagements as intrinsically structuralist and thereby incorrect, but rather to point out that an assessment of the analytic assumptions undergirding their deployment requires an *exposition* and / or *illustration* of the ways in which diverse approaches are indeed embedded within more abstract debates regarding ontology and epistemology. Furthermore, in uncovering some of the assumptions underlying a geography of film we can point more clearly toward those approaches that are presently

underdeveloped; approaches that embed themselves within *poststructuralist* conceptualizations of the world.

Our own reading of the current theoretical landscape is itself guided by those strands of poststructuralist thought that problematize: first, the 'subject's' ability to perceive the 'real' processes at work in society, as opposed to mere 'representation'; and second, the 'subject's' ability to 'represent', or articulate, those findings, without asserting a totalizing framework. As such, we introduce an initial note of caution in regard to the identification of diverse approaches to a geography of film: that is, one cannot presume such approaches to be the mere reflection of broader-scale disciplinary paradigms. From a poststructuralist stance, all investigative approaches are productive of particular assumptions regarding the status of 'truth', 'reality' and 'explanation' – these assumptions, however, often cut across the largely nominal divides marked by paradigmatic boundaries. For example, a 'modernist' commitment to locating and representing truths has recently been subject to much critique (see, for example, SOJA 1989, 1991; FOLCH-SERRA 1990; PHILO 1992; SHAPIRO 1992; and NATTER and JONES 1993, among others). Such critiques undermine not only a humanistic focus on essences, but also political economy's search for the 'real' causes of oppression in the world. Furthermore, while diverse analyses draw inspiration from that body of literature labelled 'postmodernism', there occasionally remain distinct traces of essentialism, a characteristic usually associated with political economy (see, for example, MASSEY's 1991 critique of HARVEY, and HARVEY's rebuttal 1993). Our point here is not that the accepted labels given to particular bodies of literature are incorrect, but rather that the theoretical debates currently taking place are far too nuanced for such labels to be useful. As researchers from various sub-fields engage and re-engage in these meta-theoretical debates, we should be aware of the fact that the assumptions underpinning diverse investigations of the world endeavors cut across, and produce divisions within, accepted disciplinary paradigms. This differential 'borrowing' of concepts and premises is as much a feature of landscape analysis (see, for example, BARNES and DUNCAN 1992) as it is of film analysis.

Given our intent to articulate the ramifications arising from the diverse forms of structuralism underlying geography's present engagement with film, the methodological question that arises at this point is: on what grounds do we locate key analytical stances toward a geography of film? In contrast to the potentially misleading character of a paradigmatic ordering of film research, we recognize the utility of an organizational framework based on an 'Author-Text-Reader' (A-T-R) model. This framework takes account of the common distinction many researchers have drawn, and continue to draw, between the particular 'moments' of a film's history. An initial premise made by many researchers is that film, as an object of inquiry, is constituted through the conditions surrounding its production, content, and reception by an audience. This does not mean that subsequent analyses are limited *to* a particular moment, but rather that each approach interprets the component parts of the model according to their analytic assumptions, weighs their significance in regard to the goal of inquiry, and focuses on that moment deemed to be of greatest relevance. Consequently, geography's engagement with film as an

object of inquiry has largely settled out into three analytic stances, namely author-centered, text-centered and reader-centered, approaches.¹

Our method of choice, therefore, is to organize analytic stances according to this A-T-R model, and secondly to utilize them in three separate 'readings' of a particular film, *Powaqqatsi: Life in Transformation*.² More specifically, the theoretical assumptions underpinning these analytic stances will be drawn out through an illustration of the reading that ensues from such approaches, and through an exposition of the underlying ontological and epistemological assumptions that permit these modes of reading to take place. This leads us not only to identify the diverse forms of structuralism apparent in the three major analytic stances constituting geography's current engagement, but also to explore the research 'limitations', or borders, established within each form. It is from a *post*structuralist vantage point, we hope, that alternate analyses of the ways in which social 'power' operates within film, and more generally how these myriad power relationships construe the world at large, can be articulated.

AUTHOR-CENTERED APPROACHES: FILMING CAPITAL AT WORK

An author-centered reading of film focuses on the conditions surrounding its production, and rests on the presumption that there exists a *readily communicated* meaning within that textual form. As noted in the introduction, this does not mean that the analysis is limited *to* this moment, but rather that once the premise has been made that meaning has an *origin*, the methodological focus of inquiry is guided by the need to ascertain the conditions from which particular meanings emerge. It is at the moment of production, then, that key ontological and epistemological assumptions are being made. Furthermore, in placing the focus of inquiry on this moment an analytic trajectory is established wherein the two other components of the model (content and reception) are interpreted according to how particular meanings are subsequently embedded within a text, and read by an audience.

1. Much of the interest in how to "read" film, as well as other popular modes of communication, has come from the realm of literary theory. Hence it should not be too surprising to find that geographers have repeatedly turned toward the Author-Text-Reader model used within this discipline. For an excellent review of this model and its explicit and implicit appropriation by geographers see NATTER and JONES (1993): Signposts Toward a Poststructuralist Geography, in JONES, J.P., NATTER, W. and SCHATZKI, T. (Eds.) *Beyond Modernity? Postmodernism, Politics and Space*. New York.
2. *Powaqqatsi* is a feature-length documentary film comprised of a montage of magnificently photographed images of an array of human activities in the First and Third World, all set within a wide range of physical and cultural landscapes. It is the second film in a planned trilogy by the American director Godfrey REGGIO, the first being the critically acclaimed *Koyaanisqatsi*, the third is entitled *Naqoyqatsi*. *Powaqqatsi* eschews a traditional documentary format – plot, characters, dialogue and narration – and consists instead of a series of images produced via a visually stunning array of shooting techniques, including acceleration, reverse action, microscopy and aerial shots. These movements are underscored by Philip Glass' often eerie but engaging acoustic arrangements. At the close of the film a translation appears: "Po.waq.qa.tsi (from the Hopi language, *powaq* sorcerer + *qatsi* life) n., an entity, a way of life that consumes the life forces of other beings in order to further its own life."

Such an approach has usually been associated with a humanistic conception of the individual, wherein the meaning imparted to a text is perceived to have its origin in an original, autonomous, mind; film is a product of the *auteur*. In this section we present the rather unorthodox argument that the presumptions of this approach are also present within a political economic reading of 'reality' and its 'representation'. We do so by suggesting that both approaches are underpinned by a 'modernist' imperative to impart, channel and direct the 'real', or 'true', meaning of a text. From within humanism, we can interpret that truth to be the ideals of the *auteur*. From within political economy, the meanings embedded within popular films are mere 'representations', serving to naturalize hegemonic, capitalist, discourses produced in the 'real' world, or merely distract the attention of viewers from the 'real' problems facing society (BURGESS 1985; AITKEN 1991; HOPKINS 1994; KLAK 1994; KRIM 1994). The role of the researcher is to expose the truisms hidden behind a text's ideological facade, thereby revealing the fetishistic³ quality of representation in general (NICHOLSON 1991; GODFREY 1993; BOWDEN 1994). Such an endeavor bears a marked resemblance to the role of the humanist critic, locating and articulating the 'real' intent of the author for all to see. In this section, therefore, we undertake an authorial reading of *Powaqqatsi* in order to demonstrate the readiness with which a political economic analysis of the 'real' and the 'reel' can indeed accommodate this focus on a readily communicated meaning embedded within the text.

According to the director of *Powaqqatsi*, Godfrey REGGIO, the intent behind its production was to communicate the destructive and dehumanizing impacts of capitalist development – the message of the film – more *directly* to the audience via the use of diverse, non-traditional, shooting techniques. For REGGIO, this direct, more emotive form of communication is more likely to ensure the reception and retention of such a message precisely because it is transmitted in a more visually and acoustically diffuse manner. As he puts it:

What you give up is the specificity of one thought, one idea, unmistakably getting your point across, which people can agree or disagree with. But what you do get is the richness of an experience that can stay in the conscious and the unconscious mind and can be continually revisited and serve as a source of inspiration for the viewer (quoted in DEMPSEY 1989, 21).

If we read the meaning of *Powaqqatsi* as commensurate with the message of its author, then, both the content and the format of the film must be taken into account. The first half of the movie, for example, is a paean to the moral and aesthetic value of traditional third world peasant societies: religion, hand labor, craftsmanship, and the rapprochement between village and nature are all valorized as elemental to a life in balance. The pace of the movie is slow, the camera, it seems, savoring each beautiful frame for as long as possible. "Try slowing it down", suggests REGGIO,

3. Fetishistic in this sense of the term refers to Marx's commentary on commodities, whereby they are dissociated from their material production and presented as 'abstract' things determined only by their price on the market. So too, the actual relations of power within which films are produced are hidden by the visual imagery invested in it. Most films play the role of visual ideologies, lulling the non-expert reader into a false sense of security.

"so that, in effect, it becomes monumentalized. In freezing a moment, you create a monument..." (quoted in DEMPSEY 1989, 22). In contrast, the second half explodes into action as the camera pans by activity after activity, some joyful, some comic, some nightmarish. The underlying music shifts to a pronounced and beat-insistent tone as we view the increasingly disturbing juxtapositions of people and things in what now appears to be an urban jumble. What emerges, however, is no horror show but an enticing, if somewhat confusing and ultimately dangerous, place to be: "[T]he Beast doesn't come as a baglady, it comes as a seducer, it comes bejewelled" (REGGIO, quoted in DEMPSEY 1989, 19).

In accord with this authorial intent, our reading of *Powaqqatsi* goes on to distinguish three spheres of socio-spatial 'reality' within the film. Each of these spheres we read as signifying the social regimentation, alienation and exploitation produced under a rapidly expanding capitalist economy: first, traditional peasant economies; second, the rapidly urbanizing Third World cities; and third, the dehumanized First World cities.

To begin, we see the Third World as a place of texture, rhythm, continuity and innocence. Early in the film we see below-the-waist shots of swirling dresses of dancing Altiplano women, while later we see the beautiful headdresses of the same women as we get only a suggestion of the fact that there is a rhythmic flow. Toward the end of the film the camera is pulled back and we see the group of ten or twelve women in its entirety as they slowly dance in a circle, the complete costumes swirling in rhythm, with facial expressions clear and intent. The camera focuses on a child's face at several junctures, and then, after a long pause, it slowly pans across the faces of many children standing shoulder to shoulder. Their expressions vary from indifference to curiosity to a rare smile. The camera focuses on hands that are hoeing a field, then shifts to an areal view of terraced fields with a few scattered huts – this is a mode of existence in harmony with the natural environment. In contrast, the parasitic tendrils of the global economy reach into this rural idyll and transform individuals into an anonymous, regimented, assemblage of limbs – labor in the abstract – as the camera sustains a long montage, scored percussively by GLASS, of slow-motion images of begrimed, sweating laborers carrying sacks of dirt away from a deep mine and its debris-formed and steep terraced slopes. The workers' toil seems endless and of little purpose.

The second socio-spatial sphere of activity is filmed in the metropolitan centers of core capitalist economies where livelihoods are conditioned by intensely competitive social relations of production. Human beings are conspicuously absent here and the social structure has shifted from reliance on face-to-face communication to mediated and indirect forms of interaction. In one image an abandoned and stripped car sits in the median of a highway while shadows of cars, ghost cars of the past and future, speed by in opposite directions. In another hypnotic scene a seemingly endless train of identical cars whip right to left past the camera, a solitary tree set just to the other side of the tracks. The pacing of images begins fairly rapidly then accelerates to a near frenzy: this discrete time-space compression takes us into the vortex of the modern city.

The third sphere of activity is shot in the metropolitan centers of developing countries where the two previous worlds are not only in collision, one is actively subsuming the other. It is in this setting that capitalism appears most voracious in its appetite for larger and larger quantities of human labor. Traditional cultural ties between people and to nature are dislodged as a direct consequence of the intensified demands placed on society and the physical landscape by the dominant capitalist regime of accumulation. The scenes present a sense of unbalance or turmoil, a kind of social entropy. An elderly Filipino woman walks with a package balanced on her head, while behind her a group of young men and women, perhaps high school age, are jogging in unison. Clad in homogenous uniforms and indifferent faces, they overtake her. Change is coming, and it is generic, powerful and inexorable. In another scene, a girl is driving a cart pulled by two mules in heavy vehicular traffic. She beats the mules almost continuously with a stick, but they go no faster. In another scene a young, robed boy walks alongside the road with a sense of purpose and direction. Slowly and inexorably a truck approaches from behind. The truck is churning up dust as it moves, and as it passes the boy the cloud slowly envelops him. Yet, as he slowly disappears he never loses his demeanor. When we can no longer see him, the music stops. A few moments from the very close of the movie, he materializes from the cloud as the truck passes, his step unaltered.

Within this mode of reading, we are presuming that *Powaqqatsi* presents to the viewer *real-life* processes: we are *witness* to the cultural, social and physical impacts of capitalism on the Third World, subsuming all in its seemingly endless quest for profit. The Avant Garde format of the movie is clearly a product of artifice, but the essence of the message is merely *enhanced* through such means: our awareness of the capitalist system and its consequences is heightened through this artistic medium. As such, *Powaqqatsi* adequately fulfills the role of "art as mode of explanation" demanded by one extremely influential strand of political economic thought, articulated by MARCUSE, HORKHEIMER and ADORNO. For MARCUSE (1972), culture is the arena within which contradictions within capitalism are articulated and resolved through ideological apparatus' such as the production of Art.⁴ He argues that the 'transcendental' ideals of happiness and beauty celebrated in Art are merely the product of bourgeoisie ideology – the false message imparted by Art is that such ideals are present *in reality*. He writes,

... [the bourgeois epoch's] decisive characteristic is the assertion of a universally obligatory, eternally better and more valuable world that must be unconditionally confirmed: a world essentially different from the factual world of daily struggle for existence, and yet realizable by every individual for himself 'from within', without any transformation of the state of fact. It is only in this culture that cultural activities and objects gain that value which elevates them above the everyday sphere. Their reception becomes an act of celebration and exaltation (MARCUSE 1972, 75).

4. While the examples used by MARCUSE, HORKHEIMER and ADORNO to distinguish High and Low culture (i.e., Art versus popular vehicles such as film) are inappropriate to our argument, the impetus behind this categorization of texts remains valid. According to the director of *Powaqqatsi*, this film is indeed intended to be an art form, rather than popular entertainment (see DEMPSIEY 1989).

Art glides over the misery of the working class, and persuades those who have access to its thrall that all is well. According to HORKHEIMER and ADORNO (1973), Avant Garde Art breaks this ideological function. The audience is no longer presented with an image that reinscribes a normal relationship between them as subjects and the capitalist form of society: through its very artificiality, Avant Garde Art draws attention to its social origins, forcing the viewer to reevaluate their accepted, taken-for-granted, role in society.

Within this political economic positioning of the role of film as a mode of social discourse, there is simultaneously a rejection of the individualism present in an authorial approach to the text, and a privileging of the individual's capacity to become aware of, and comment on, their 'true' place in society. HORKHEIMER and ADORNO are articulating a particular, structural view of the social world, in which the notion of an autonomous 'mind' is rejected in favor of a materialist explanation of subjectivity. Materialist, in this sense, refers to the presumption that ideas, or attitudes / beliefs are not immanent categories of the mind. They are, rather, dependent upon the input of data from a knowable world composed of intersubjective meanings, inherited values, institutionalized roles and social norms. While such norms and mores are not the *direct* product of the economic base of society, the 'real' place of the individual in society, and the way in which that individual conceives of their role in society, hinges upon their relationship to the mode of production. This particular theorization of the production of subjectivity has been expanded considerably by ALTHUSSER (1971, 233), who writes:

In ideology men ... express, not the relation between them and their conditions of existence, but the way they live the relation between them and their conditions of existence: this presupposes both a real relation and an 'imaginary', lived relation. Ideology ... is the expression of the relation between men and their 'world', that is, the (overdetermined) unity of the real relation and the imaginary relation between them and their real conditions of existence.

We can read *Powaqqatsi*, therefore, to be an instance wherein the author's ideological commentary on capitalism, and the 'real' social structure produced under capitalism coincide. Such a normative rendering of the film, however, depends upon a presumption shared by both humanism and this particular form of political economy; that is, a belief in the freeing powers of thought and language, such that individual's have the capacity to appreciate and comment on their own and others' 'true' place in society.

In drawing out the analytic assumptions underpinning this approach we can locate a certainty in regard to the *objective* status of the researcher and the *factuality* of capitalist domination which, from a poststructuralist standpoint, poses considerable limitations. As recent reviews point out, for example, the presumption of a dichotomy between 'reality' and mere 'representation' allows the researcher to take an authoritative position outside of the world they are claiming to research (DEUTSCHE 1990, 1991; JONES 1995). DEUTSCHE (1990, 133) problematizes this characterization of the 'real' and the 'reel' by pointing toward its accompanying strategy of *exclusion*, in that the grandiose claim that only one approach accurately re-presents reality necessarily denies the legitimacy of all other modes of explanation:

A commanding position on the battleground of representation – one that denies the partial and fragmented conditions of vision by claiming to 'perceive' a total truth – is an illusionary place whose construction, motivated by wishes, entails hallucinations and hysterical blindness. It is a position constructed in a form of knowledge that produces total – unfragmented – subjects.

DEUTSCHE's comment on the difference between 'perception', which is the process of assembling material phenomena into recognizable forms, and 'vision', which is a socially constructed way of looking at the world, problematizes *any* claim toward accurate reflection of the real world. The image and the act of viewing are relations highly mediated by wishes, fantasies, etc. Within her conceptualization, there is no easy epistemological assumption that reality can be perceived once the ideological obfuscations of capitalism have been removed.

We can further problematize the ontological certainty underpinning this form of political economy by exploring the limitations placed on the concept of 'representation' within this approach. The term is used to indicate an image or symbol that, through its emplacement within a mode of communication, is presumed to provide either an accurate or false rendering of reality. Just as the researcher can, through the representational form of language, articulate an accurate or false portrayal of 'reality', so other producers can reveal, or obfuscate, that 'reality' through a variety of representational mediums such as film. The underlying presumption here is that language and other forms of communication are either transparent reflections of reality (accurate representations) or deliberately opaque (false representations). If we consider this conceptualization in explicitly semiotic terms, then the presumption being made is that a 'real' world object (the signified) is safely and securely rendered by a particular 'representation' (the signifier), and that there can be no confusion as to what that representation is indeed referring to.⁵ This unproblematic link between signified and signifier can be considered the 'natural' state of affairs. Falsification occurs when the 'natural' link between signified and signifier is hidden, or dismissed; the signified is represented by the 'wrong' signifiers, which can now be considered (mis)representations (KLAK 1994; KRIM 1994).

The problematic nature of this ontological stance becomes clearer when we consider the ramifications of just such a claim to accurate representation. In regard to *Powaqqatsi*, if capitalism (the signified) is indeed truly rendered through the signification of it as exploitative, regimentative and inauthentic, then we must

5. This emphasis on the arbitrary association between signifieds and signifiers ensues from the work of SAUSSURE. In contrast to a traditional focus within semiotics on the origins of language – wherein it was presumed that the link between a word and its real world referent had been established in ancient times – SAUSSURE articulated the theory that each language was in fact a system to be analyzed in light of its structural character. SAUSSURE argued that words and other signs derive their value not from their referencing of real world objects, but from their difference to other signs. The real world objects labelled as 'trees', for example, could equally well be referenced by any other term. The word 'tree', therefore, derives its value from the difference that can be noted between it and another term such as 'shrub'. Within this approach, the focus of inquiry is directed toward the conventions by which the word 'tree' is maintained as an appropriate term for these real world objects.

presume that other 'realities' depicted in the film, such as *non*-capitalist Third World cultures, are also accurately rendered. If all manner of social ills are laid at the door of an expanding global economy, the construction of a traditional, peasant, rural idyll *must* then be valorized as constitutive of all of the opposite characteristics, i.e., harmony, rhythm and innocence, and of course, authenticity. In conflating all Third World cultures with a 'pure', environmentally harmonious way of life; however, we reiterate the colonial notion that Third World cultures are *non*-modern, *non*-technological – they are *of* the past. The major social cleavage produced and legitimized under colonialism – that between colonizer and colonized, First and Third World – is once again reiterated as *the* initial means of cataloguing humanity.

If the link between Third World societies (the signified) and terms such as 'primitive', 'authentic', and so on, is not a 'natural' one, but is rather the product of particular colonial practices; then the larger principle to be drawn is not that the link between signified and signifier is indeed arbitrary, but that the links that do emerge are themselves the product of, and productive of, social relations of power. With this principle in mind, a poststructuralist examination of the power of 'representation' can follow, as indeed will be shown in later sections. However, semiotics as a body of literature is also productive of its own structuralist logic, and it is this strand of thought that has invigorated our next topic, namely text-centered approaches to a geography of film.

TEXT-CENTERED APPROACHES: ENGAGING THE EXPERT READER

A text-centered approach assumes that the link between signifier and signified is actively constructed and maintained by 'real' world social relations of power. Such an approach, therefore, maintains two presumptions noted in the previous section, namely that there are originary (albeit complex) conditions out of which meaning emerges, and that there is a dichotomy between the 'real' and mere 'representation'. However, in further presuming that the linkages made between the real (the signified) and its representation (the signifier) are the product of artifice, the focus of inquiry shifts toward an examination of the textual strategies used to produce particular meanings. In effect, the text becomes a battleground: on the one side powerful social groups propose to 'accurately' represent reality, while on the other the researcher 'uncovers' the hypocrisy of such claims and points toward the 'true' state of affairs. In engaging the dominant ideologies embedded in textual forms such as film, the researcher becomes an 'expert reader', locating the obvious and the hidden, the true and the false, the message and the subtext. While such an analytic stance has usually been associated with a particular strand of political economy – one which recognizes the power of the symbolic in the constitution of social relations – in this section we go on to argue that it is also a feature of those textual-centered analyses that draw on the concept of 'intertextuality', a term usually associated with poststructuralism. This selective 'borrowing' is, in turn, productive of certain limitations in regard to an investigation of the social world.

The drive to interrogate the embeddedness and 'naturalization' of dominant ideologies in texts such as film has had an immense impact on those analyses which

firmly place themselves within a structuralist rubric. In undertaking research on popular media, for example, BURGESS (1990) examines the means by which one side of a binary has been legitimized within the text, such that the audience is 'cued' to interpret meaning in particular ways. Using the work of HALL on the production and consumption of codes of meaning, BURGESS is at pains to point out that while the link between signified and signifier is arbitrary, there is an intent on behalf of the various producers of imagery to 'position' the reader such that they are liable to infer the intended 'message'. 'Framing' devices, intertextual references to other ideas and concepts and so on, have come increasingly under scrutiny by researchers interested in how the media 'works' (DER DERIAN 1992; STAM 1992; Ó'TUATHAIL 1993, 1994; SHARPE 1993; DALBY 1994; MACDONALD 1994). While capitalism has certainly remained a prime suspect in the production of such ideologies, other social structures, such as race and patriarchy, have also been posited as providing the originary moment out of which meaning emerges.

In the battle to uncover the means by which meaning is embedded in a text, an auxiliary tactic has been to actively harness the realm of the symbolic. Within this approach, there is a recognition of the fact that all real world processes are in fact articulated through symbolism, such that the expert reader can never actually succeed in uncovering the 'real' in and of itself. Rather, one can only use a representational form such as language to signify that underlying reality as persuasively as possible. As DANIELS (1989, 200–201) summarizes this pragmatic representation of meaning on behalf of a politically aware academia:

In acknowledging the iconographic power and even constitution of society and social description, Western Marxists have been both iconoclastic – in attempting to dismantle the illusory power of images to reach an actual or at least authentic world, and idolatrous – in accepting that such a world is no longer tenable and that the appropriate strategy is to harness the power of imagery against capital or at least in a way that will make sense of its workings.

Examples of the latter tactic range from HARVEY's (1989) commentary on *Blade Runner* to NATTER and JONES' (1993) appraisal of *Roger and Me*. Within these analyses, not only are the cultural ramifications of an exploitative capitalism tellingly signified, but also the 'spaces' of resistance to be found within the chosen texts.

The "idolatry" noted by DANIELS can also, however, be found within another approach to film analysis, one that is usually associated with a poststructuralist school of thought. Drawing inspiration from the work of BARTHES and DERRIDA, geographers such as AITKEN (1991, 1993) have pointed out the varied 'subtexts' embedded within symbolic media. Within this conceptualization of 'representation' there is no simple origin to ideology, but rather a host of overlapping discourses that play off each other in new combinations. Importantly, however, these discourses are shaped according to the wishes and demands of the dominant groups in society. In the act of producing, and reading, texts, the meanings that can be achieved through the combination of associations are infinite. The term 'intertextuality' captures this constantly fluid movement from one meaning to another through a wide variety of social texts that make up our world. To put this in semiotic terms, signifiers do not reference underlying signifieds, but rather other signifiers, such that meaning is

always in process; meaning is but a temporary stop in a continuing flow of interpretations of interpretations. It is only when a sign is located in a context and read in a context that there is a temporary halt to the endless play of signifier and signifier (BARTHES 1985). Even here, though, context cannot fully control meaning precisely because neither is fully present. Meaning will resonate throughout other contexts, brought into play by the very act of reading.

Given this intertextuality, or fluidity of meaning, the presumption can be retained that social structures operating in the 'real' world govern the production and consumption of such meanings, effectively 'fixing' them in the 'reel' world. In focusing their attention on 'subtexts', film geographers are locating what are perceived to be the results of these power relations, as some associations between signifiers are made to appear 'natural' or commonsensical within the film, thereby rendering them invisible to the non-expert reader. As with a political economic text-centered approach, therefore, images are regarded as the embodiment of real world power relations – the difference being that geographers such as AITKEN (1991, 1993) and ROSE (1994) point to the operation of a host of social structures including capitalism, patriarchy and race. In consequence, there can be no simple delineation of a dominant ideology within texts; there are instead intersecting, conflated and at times oppositional 'subtexts' that must be uncovered if their power is to be defused.

Film analysis, then, becomes a matter not of exposing the original intent behind various 'messages', but rather of deconstructing the ways in which the message itself articulates particular commonsense notions. For AITKEN (1993) and AITKEN and ZONN (1993), deconstruction proceeds via the identification of couplets or binaries. Within these couplets, such as male and female, or good and bad, one side is valued over the other through its association with particular connotations. The valued side is considered fully 'present', in that it is the origin for defining what is *not* it, or in other words, what is the 'other', or mere supplement. Poststructuralist empirics become a matter of breaching the 'closed' character of an intentional meaning or message in order to reveal their artificial (i.e., socially constructed) character. That which has been designated as 'privileged', e.g., the masculine, the rational, the reasoned, and the ordered, must be overthrown via the uncovering within the text of their simultaneously excluded and subsumed others, the feminine, the irrational, the unreasonable, and the chaotic.

By way of application, our own expert reading of *Powaqqatsi* locates those 'hidden' binaries (Figure 1.) proposed by AITKEN and ZONN (1993) amongst others, noting the ways in which various associations have been made within the film between real world objects and particular representations. We begin in a Moroccan setting of desert colors, as the camera follows a woman in flowing bright red robes slowly enters a walled village; the camera stays outside the walls but moves to the left in order to follow her progress. Once she disappears, the camera slowly circles around more walls until another entrance is reached, whereupon it slowly and hesitantly enters. In our rural idyll, the villages consist of enclosure within enclosure, all colored from the brown earth and nestled between the folds of gently rounded hills. The statuesque curves of the terraced fields mirror the meandering rivers below. Everything, it seems, is formed out of circles. The swaying bodies of

Figure 1. Locating the Subtexts in *Powaqqatsi*

The Supplemental		The Fully Present
female	-----	male
nature	-----	culture
tradition	-----	progress
sexuality	-----	lust
pure	-----	corrupt
community	-----	individuation
freedom	-----	regimentation

women are swathed in flowing garments, while the strong-limbed bodies of men cleave through the elements – earth, sea and wind – cutting a pathway forward. The women carry receptacles, the men carry knives, sticks, a rudder.

The parasitic tendrils of a rapidly expanding capitalist economy transform men into drudges, laboring day after day in vast complexes of machinery and earthworks. The villages are now the provenance of women and children, as families become scattered across space. Railway tracks and highways cut across the landscape while planes fly in and out of cities: the movement of goods and people, commodities all, seems endless. Our introduction to the market places and residences of the towns and cities is via an increasing number of angles – square fields, square houses – until at last the edifices of churches, office blocks and apartment buildings reach into the sky, the camera gazing upward in awe. The apartment houses are now so high they seem to loom, forcing the surrounding mountains to become a mere backdrop in comparison. The city lights up in neon as goods and people continue to flash across the screen. Within the city, advertisements crowd in, selling hair products and make-up; with the arrival of these First World icons natural sexuality gives way to artificial lust and longing. Individual movement is no longer a natural expression, but has become a regimented posture as bands of soldiers and young girls march through the streets.

Given this textual reading of the signifiers present in *Powaqqatsi*, how do we proceed to uncover and defuse the subtexts embedded here? To begin we might note that while the producers of the film have recognized and combated the ‘commonsense’ discourse that links the signifiers of capitalism, progress, equality, and beneficence, they have also *unproblematically* incorporated various ‘subtexts’. For example, no matter what area of the world is being displayed within *Powaqqatsi*, there is a continuing dichotomy between female and male spaces. Women work in the villages, the place of home and hearth, while men till the fields and navigate the rivers. Furthermore, through the association of the bodies of women with the hills and valleys of the countryside, the discourse by which women are

portrayed as 'of nature', rather than 'civilization', is maintained (see AITKEN and ZONN 1993, for further explication of this forceful stereotype). One might argue that it is the blatant presence of these associations that give them power: presented as unproblematically 'natural' ways of thinking about the world, these associations are *subtexts* in the sense that they are almost, but not quite, beyond question. Indeed, it is only the expert reader who can locate and identify them as such.

While the impulse to open up commonsensical or naturally given meanings to critical scrutiny is a laudable one, from a poststructuralist viewpoint there are certain limitations within this text-centered approach. Within these analyses, meanings are taken as intrinsically fluid in the 'reel' world, the realm of the symbolic. There remains the presumption, however, that a fixed power relationship between dominant and subordinate subjects exists in the 'real' world. Intertextuality, or the deferral of an 'absolute' meaning, has been limited to the screen. The presumption of a stable, or *fixed*, power relationship between 'central' and 'othered' discourses, therefore, relies on a form of structuralism, whereby certain social relations of dominance and subordination 'fix' the subject position of individuals.

The ramifications of this structuralism become more apparent if we consider the conceptualization of the 'subject' that ensues from such a stance. In the work of some feminists, for example, the binary opposition of male-female is *the* focus of film research: the filmic privileging of the former is taken as a fixed, or determined, power relation that merely re-inscribes patriarchal relations in the real world (MULVEY 1975, 1981; KUHN 1982, 1985, 1990; DE LAURETIS 1984). As a result, the female viewer is forced into insubordinate, or surreptitious, glances that seek to avoid this patriarchal rendering of the feminine (GAINES 1988; GAMMAN and MARSHMENT 1989). The problem here is not that such a conceptualization of the subject is necessarily 'incorrect', but rather that the results of one's film analysis are wholly *expected*; that is, not only is the identification of subtexts a product of the researchers' own assessment of the present status of real world power relations, but also there is no room within this approach for representations to transform or challenge one's presumption of what those real world relations are. The dichotomy presumed by text-centered approaches between the 'real' and its mere 'representation' is one of causal connection: the real governs the non-real. From a poststructuralist viewpoint, this binary must itself be problematized.

One entry point by which this deconstruction can proceed is via the largely undertheorized concept of 'looking'. As CORRIGAN (1991) suggests, the relationship between viewer and image, the 'real' and the 'reel' world, is itself a socially mediated process, and as such is a product of diverse relations of domination and subordination. The privileged place of the 'expert' viewer, for example, is the product of a particular Western conflation of 'objective' observation with the role of the 'academic' (GREGORY 1994; JONES 1995) – a conflation that has legitimized, and thereby facilitated the maintenance of, a voyeuristic relationship between 'First' and 'Third' World. As SPIVAK (1988) notes, voyeurism is a power relation that constitutes, and is constituted by, the viewer and the viewed: while the latter are certainly rendered 'visible' by expert accounts such as film analyses, they are present *within* the expert's economics of signification. It is toward a theorization of the relation between viewer and viewed that the next section turns.

READER-CENTERED APPROACHES: LOCATING THE OTHER

A reader-centered approach focuses on the means by which meaning is perceived, or "poached" (DE CERTEAU 1984, 174), from the text. Within this mode of reading, viewing is conceived of as a fluid process of appropriation, resistance and selection of images – a process that allows the viewer to become their own authority (CORRIGAN 1991). Indeed, it is through this appropriation that the discursive power relations within which the viewer is embedded are re-negotiated. Rather than presume fixed dominant and subordinate subject positions, therefore, this mode of reading emphasizes the myriad discourses each 'subject' is engaged within (ECO 1979; CORRIGAN 1991). It is the *diversity* of audience reception that becomes the focus of inquiry.

While a reader-centered approach is usually associated with an idealist stance in regard to the essential uniqueness of individual world views, we argue that this mode of reading also incorporates those approaches that lay claim to 'decenter' the subject, an impulse drawn from poststructuralism. In following through the reader-centered mode of analysis – that is, an appreciation of the socially mediated reception of meaning – it is the production of subjectivity that becomes the locus for reconceptualization and analysis. We would agree that this task is indeed critical, for it raises an issue all too often taken for granted: that is, the means by which 'personality', 'behavior' and 'self' are constructed from social relations of power. As noted earlier in regard to both author- and text-centered approaches these concepts have generally been taken as the product of dominant ideologies, or hegemonies, wherein the individual's imagined relationship with society, or 'place in the world', is constituted from existent norms and mores. At the basis of this formulation is a commitment to real world structures, or conditions of existence, directing the formulation and implementation of such ideologies. Where a reader-centered approach breaches this formulation is in its emphasis on the multiplicity of discourses each individual is interpellated by, such that there is no one 'subject position' to be held by an individual, but rather multiple, and conflicting, positionalities. This multiplicity is furthered by the interposition of dominant discourses with the unconscious – an insight that has revived interest in geography's engagement with psychoanalysis (PILE 1993). In a reader-centered approach, then, it is the multitude, and intersection, of economies of signification that becomes the object of interest.

By way of exposition, the following is a reading of *Powaqqatsi* by a group of thirty university students in a junior-level environmental perception course. The students were given one week to complete the following: write a three to five page paper describing your images of the film, distinguish its basic themes, and identify what the title has to do with the film. The fact that the film consists of a collage-like series of images unlike most cinematic experiences was noted by almost all students. The perceived themes of the movie were quite varied. Certainly, everyone was cognizant of the fact that this was a film about the less developed world, but the similarities ended there. Most of the perceived themes, however, fell into one of the following categories, listed in order of the frequency with which they were cited:

- (1) human-environment relations and the impact of technology,
- (2) the nature of work and survival,
- (3) movement,
- (4) culture and values,
- (5) children, gender and the nature of the family.

As can be seen from Table 1, the role of technology in transforming the human-environment relationship was a prominent theme, stated both in general terms and in regard to the technological superiority of the First World. Many students mentioned the fact that people could be seen walking throughout the film, while the scene that focussed for a full minute upon a train passing through the countryside was noted by several, particularly in terms of the symbolism of technology in a physical wasteland. The nature of family, especially children, was noted on occasion, while gender was infrequently noticed as an element of the less developed world. The role of women in society was specifically addressed by only one student. In regard to *powaqqatsi*, the entity that consumes all in order to further its own life, technology and change were the most often-cited culprits, while the role of individuals and groups as the cause of change were mentioned on occasion. A few were explicit in their characterization of the developed world as *powaqqatsi*.

Table 1. A Class Reading of *Powaqqatsi* (Part 1)

Format:

"In a way it reminds me of the movie *Lawnmower Man*, and the flashing images that teach you things at a faster rate."

"... the 'images' of the geographic 'places' replaced the dialogue and told their own story... The viewer must literally 'think' about the messages being portrayed as if they were reading a script instead of seeing the images."

Major Issues:

(1) Human-Environment Relations and the Impacts of Technology:

"By using silent images, the director allows the audience to obtain their own personal and unique perception of the relationship between technology and culture."

"... technology is miraculous all over the developed worlds, while the Third world is left in dust. It is like they are forgotten. They cannot hang with the rest of the powerful countries."

(2) The Nature of Work and Survival:

"One of the obvious images is that manual labor overwhelms the life of many in these less developed regions ... everyone in the family works, including the children."

"The movie ... is basically about the different ways of life on our planet ... about showing how hard the less fortunate people in this world work and that the people who are better off should be more grateful for what they have."

*Table 1. A Class Reading of Powaqatsi (Part 2)***(3) Movement:**

"I was especially awe-struck by the overall continuance of movement of everything in the movie ... the people who were carrying things seemed to dance for the camera. The water scenes seemed to have rhythm. Even the aerial scenes had rhythm. Everything moved to ultimately keep your attention."

(4) Culture and Values:

"They have nothing, but they have so much inside. They are not trying to keep up with the Jones'."

"... it did not appear to be all that bad, there seemed to be some beauty within their environment and within the cultures itself. Even though they live in relative poverty they keep their culture ... The physical labor doesn't stop their work, as their cultural celebration is portrayed by dancing and chanting rituals."

(5) Children, Gender and the Nature of the Family:

"One of the main themes in this movie was the burden which is put on children in less developed regions of the world..."

"Families tend to stay together throughout their entire lives. They work, eat, sleep, and entertain each other day after day. Families of the Third World seem to have very strong morals and beliefs."

"Many times they showed young girls working much like their mothers... but on the other end of the spectrum, the boys were running around and having fun... This aspect of the movie confused me... Both the men and women worked as they were older but the boys got to play while the girls did the manual labor."

Defining Powaqatsi:

"The essence of a people's culture and beliefs are being sacrificed for the spread of technology in lesser developed nations."

"A person cannot progress through technological advances, and at the same time totally keep the heritage."

"... we humans are the consumers of Mother Earth and all she has to offer. However, we as humans also consume each other, the poor people in a Third World country work for their overlords as human mules, which makes a twisted government or the few wealthy people even richer, who, in turn feed the fully developed countries that have an insatiable hunger for more."

"The definition ... I believe deals with the exploitation of the Third World by the wealthier nations of the world. The entity in this case would be the wealthier nations. The consumption would then be how those wealthier nations use the resources of the Third World for their benefit and prosperity. Although aid is given to the Third World by many countries the overall repression toward the Third World will always exist so that the rich can get richer, thus making themselves more powerful."

"The United States and other first world countries use these under developed countries as guinea pigs. Whether or not that is wrong depends on the individual and his / her feeling towards Third World cultures."

Granted that each student has 'poached' images from the film and re-presented meaning in their own 'individual' fashion, the question arises as to how we subsequently interpret and contextualize such readings? One reader-centered approach that explicitly critiques the modernist presumption of an integrated, conscious, rational self, or subject, has been articulated by AITKEN and ZONN (1993, 1994). As they explain their Lacanian approach, the self is fragmented at an early age as a sense of 'identity' emerges; this identity is not predicated, however, in the conscious realization of an inner being, but rather in the unconscious dependence on socially mediated symbols for the expression of that identity. While the conscious mind (the realm of the Imaginary) presumes a transparent reality, the unconscious desires to locate identity within the Symbolic order, which consists of modes of discourse such as language. Because symbols can never actually 'contain' meaning, this desire can never be fulfilled, but must always be deferred. In consequence, while the Symbolic order can provide a sense of self *awareness*, the self is constantly in search of new 'moments' within that order by which its identity can be fully expressed. The self is in search of the 'Other'; that is, those fragments of meaning that express the self, but are produced within the social realm. It is because films are purportedly representations of reality, or real modes of existence, that the viewer seeks within the reel world those lost fragments, selecting out image-events that heighten a sense of belonging to the real world. As the audience watches, such moments on screen the reel and the real worlds are combined. The reel / real world becomes an arena wherein the othered fragments of identity can be re-appropriated, at least while the lights are down. For AITKEN and ZONN (1993), textual analysis becomes a means of tracing the presence of those Other, socially produced, fragments, and noting the ways in which they are re-presented on the screen for audience consumption (see also ZONN and AITKEN 1994).

Within this theorization of the production of subjectivity there remains, however, more than a trace of structuralism. Importantly, for Lacan, the Other is signified by the female, in that the first instance of detachment or decentering occurs when the bond between mother and child is broken by the presence of the Father, who evokes the Symbolic order: the search for the Other, then, is a nostalgic desire for that intimate bond. Because this bond can never be re-attained, the feminine as a form of identity can also never be fully achieved. To put this another way, there is no essential identity that can be located and labelled 'feminine', but rather a continuous deferral of the feminine ideal. As feminist writers have pointed out, such a theorization may be poststructuralist in the sense that it is anti-essentialist; however, feminine identities are always considered the Other, or abnormal in some manner (see STACEY 1993, for a summary of this argument). Furthermore, male identities are considered as constituting the Symbolic order, wherein meaning is assessed, articulated and used in a 'rational' manner. Patriarchy, then, consists of much more than mere real world power relations between men and women; it is both a product of, and productive of, our conscious and unconscious notions of 'male' and 'female'. As such, patriarchy as a social structure not only operates across the boundary between 'psyche' and 'reality' – through its role in the production of identity patriarchy is necessary to the very notion of a boundary between 'self' and the world.

In sharp contrast to an idealist approach to reader responses, therefore, an approach that focuses attention on the decentering of the subject must take account of those *socially produced* symbols embedded within the text that evoke meaning for the reader. While the lost bond with the Mother cannot be attained, the self desires and seeks out substitutes for this identity. In semiotic terms, the Symbolic order becomes an endless chain of signifiers, each signifying both the lack of, and the possibility of, identity. These signifiers are, in turn, produced through socially mediated discourses (or, as PILE 1993, terms them, "semiotic laws") on the nature of race, class and, of course, patriarchy. There is no *one* determining hegemonic discourse fixing the subjectivity of individuals. Rather, each empirical instance is an exemplar of the intersection of these semiotic laws within which identities are fixed as either dominant or subordinate. As noted in the previous section, this theorization of the subject is not necessarily incorrect – rather, it is problematic in the sense that there are no surprises to be gained from this type of analysis. As with the expert reader of texts, the expert interpreter of readers must project broad-scale ideologies – 'objectivism', 'racism', 'scientism' and so on – into the analyses of their subjects. These analyses must then be conceived of as mere *responses* to the imposition of those broad-scale ideologies. In place of the one reader duped by capitalism, we have multiple subjects enmeshed in a complex web of semiotic laws.

Finally, in regard to studies that focus on the unique intersection of ideologies in the conscious / unconscious mind of individuals, we interject the cautionary note that the epistemological foundation for these ideologies, or 'shared' discourses, has been presumed rather than posited – an elision that by default invokes the specter of structuralism. The notion of broad-scale ideologies, or semiotic laws, necessitates the presumption of fixed power relations operating to produce dominant discourses. While the intent of such approaches may have been to undermine the determinism of ALTHUSSER's concept of ideology, such reader-centered approaches undermine the concept of center-margin, but only through the *multiplication* of center-margin relations throughout society. The presumption that a structural relation exists between centered and marginalized subject positions is actually retained.

CONCLUSION: A POSTSTRUCTURALIST RESEARCH AGENDA

It would seem from our reassessment of the major analytical stances toward a geography of film that, from a poststructuralist perspective, there is no easy or safe reading of this or indeed any textual form. This is because each of the readings we have illustrated rely on, and reinforce, certain structuralist presumptions concerning the character of social relations. More specifically, each mode of reading points toward a particular way in which power is deployed in a unidirectional manner within a social totality, such that one can assess how and why the roles of the dominant and the dominated are produced. To conceive of film as a mere ideological tool, for example, as do author-centered approaches, is to presume a society wherein power is a matter of coercion and persuasion between autonomous, or Cartesian, subjects, linked by their participation within a shared, hegemonic, discourse. Similarly, if we locate the various 'subtexts' within media, as do text-

centered approaches, we must then assess not only the question of how such meanings are produced through a variety of shared discourses, but also of how 'real' world power relations govern those meanings considered 'given', or 'common-sense'. While reader-centered approaches decenter the notion of a Cartesian subject, the presumption concerning shared discourses is retained on the basis that such interactions are part and parcel of the Symbolic order to which all individuals must ascribe.

From a poststructuralist vantage point, the limitations established within these forms of analyses stem from the basic premise all make that there indeed exists a social 'totality'. Such approaches recognize that all meanings and identities are relational in the sense that there is no essential core to either: meanings and identities are symbols, located and defined according to their difference from other symbols. However, while the arbitrary character of all meanings and identities has been taken as a given, the presumption has then been made that the association between signifier and signified (in case of author-centered approaches) and signifier and signifier (in the case of text- and reader-centered approaches) is not only fixed, at least temporarily, but also communicated *in the same form to all members of society*. To put this another way, a social totality is actually the product of the effective transfer of these associations within symbolic modes of communication such as film. Critical analyses of symbolic texts must then revolve around the questions of which discourses are being deployed, how they are being effectively transferred, and to the benefit of whom?

We would suggest that the ontological presumptions underpinning these questions, while laudable in intent, have led to a theoretical and methodological cul de sac in regard to the critical analysis of 'representation' and 'power'. Within the methodologies discussed, the focus of inquiry always proceeds from an existing 'shared' discourse, that may be uncritically consumed, negotiated or transgressed by the everyday reader, or actively uncovered and defused by the expert reader. How, then, can we reach beyond this current conceptualization of a geography of film, locating new research thresholds? How can we proceed to a poststructuralist reading of film as well as other modes of communication? At a theoretical level, we can problematize the notion of a shared discourse by pointing to the work of DERRIDA (1978a, 1978b), wherein the recognition of the relational character of all symbols leads him to argue that there is no 'center' and 'margin' within discourses, but rather a constantly shifting 'constitutive outside'. DERRIDA suggests that the 'difference' between meanings initially noted by SAUSSURE is not the creation of a 'space' in between things, for such a notion would retain the illusion that ideas and elements of the material world can be defined in relation only to themselves. Meanings can only be defined in relation to what they are not. Because this absence (what is not) is essential to the construction of meaning, it is present as a 'trace' within meaning, hidden by the seeming 'presence' of the thing or idea in question. This concept of the required presence and absence of the other is summed up in DERRIDA's use of the term "constitutive outside". For DERRIDA, it is only through this embeddedness, or incorporation of the other, that a communication system can actually operate, because it allows for the process of differentiation to take place

between what would otherwise be wholly disparate elements. Given this constitutive outside to all signifiers, there can be no simply derived relationship between central and marginal meanings (or as AITKEN 1993, would put it, 'text' and 'subtext'). As FOUCAULT (1980, 100) notes:

... we must not imagine a world of discourse divided between accepted discourse and excluded discourse, or between the dominant discourse and the dominated one; but as a multiplicity of discursive elements that can come into play in various strategies.

Furthermore, from this perspective, the temporary 'fixing' of signifiers in relation to each other is not only a losing battle, but merely one tactic possible in using signifiers to communicate meaning. Alternate strategies, such as allegory and irony, rely on the proliferation of meanings, as the possible associations between signifiers proceed toward infinity. For DIXON and JONES (1996, 769), the arbitrary character of the moments embedded in any system of thought can be exposed through the practice of allegory, which refuses to take any meaning as fixed or stable. Using a Derridean understanding of communication, they argue that:

As the endless conveyance of meaning from one context to another, allegory generates a potentially infinite number of associations between narratives, thereby deliberately refusing the rigidification of categorical designations, fixed meanings, and literal truth. Thus, while any one narrative may presume to fix meaning as "literal" ... the practice of allegory disrupts these certainties by bringing the narrative into play with that of another. As a consequence, under allegory no narrative can retain its fixed and essential character, thus providing the allegorist with insight into the construction of meaning and the oppositional traces it relies upon.

DERRIDA also provides the inspiration for DOEL (1993) and DOEL and CLARKE's (1996) ironic commentary on the nature of the 'real' and 'representation'. The impetus behind their deployment of irony is not critical detachment, as SMITH (1996) has suggested, but a progressive politics wherein meaning is constantly unhinged from any and all fixed moorings. Within their work, irony is the vehicle by which a constant transfer of signifiers between localized discursive communities takes place. These communities are linked not by a 'shared' understanding of terms, but through the production and recognition of a proliferation of associations between signifiers and, thereby, meanings.

Both allegory and irony, therefore, are becoming legitimate research strategies, as well as objects of analysis, for academics. There remains, however, a strong prejudice against the using of these and similar forms of analysis – a prejudice based on the notion that the goal of academic research into 'representation' is the uncovering and re-presentation of 'shared' discourses. Dismissed as mere 'postmodern' forms of play, allegorical and ironic methodologies have been berated for their lack of an obvious (that is, fixed) meaning (see, for example, critiques launched by JAMESON 1981, 1992, 1993, 1995, and in *Geography* by BEAUREGARD 1988, and HARVEY 1989, 1992, 1993). As we have argued, this critique is unnecessarily dismissive, in that it is underpinned by a structuralist commitment to the notion of a social 'totality'. If research into representation and power is to reach new thresholds, the limitations established by structuralism must be problematized and overcome. In sum, there must be the recognition that the much heralded "crisis of representation" (see, for example, the debate by COSGROVE 1994, and DEAR

1994) bemoaned by those still adhering to the 'commonsense' status of structuralist research is no crisis at all, but rather an exploration of the diverse forms of inquiry and explanation available to researchers.

REFERENCES

- AITKEN, S.C. (1991): A transactional geography of the image-event: the films of Scottish director, Bill Forsyth. *Transactions of the Institute of British Geographers*, N.S. 16, 105-118.
- AITKEN, S.C. (1993): I'd Rather Watch the Movie than Read the Book. *Journal of Geography in Higher Education* 18 (3), 291-307.
- AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (1993): Wier(d) sex: representation of gender-environment relations in Peter Weir's *Picnic at Hanging Rock* and *Gallipoli*. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 11 (2), 191-212.
- AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (1994): Re-Presenting the Place Pastiche. AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (Eds.): *Place, Power, Situation and Spectacle*. Savage, Maryland, 3-25.
- ALTHUSSER, L. (1971): Ideology and Ideological State Apparatuses'. *Lenin and Philosophy and other Essays*. London, 121-173.
- BARNES, T. and J. DUNCAN (Eds.) (1992): *Writing Worlds: Discourse, Text and Metaphor in the Representation of Landscape*. New York.
- BARTHES, R. (1985): Day by Day with Roland Barthes. BLONSKY, M. (Ed.): *On Signs*. London, 98-117.
- BEAUREGARD, R.A. (1988): In the absence of practice: the locality research debate. *Antipode* 20 (1), 52-59.
- BOWDEN, M.J. (1994): Jerusalem, Dover Beach, and King's Cross: Imagined Places as Metaphors of the British Class Struggle in *Chariots of Fire* and *The Loneliness of the Long-Distance Runner*. AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (Eds.): *Place, Power, Situation and Spectacle*. Savage, Maryland, 69-100.
- BURGESS, J. (1985): News From Nowhere: the press, the riots and the myth of the inner city. BURGESS, J. and J.R. GOLD (Eds.): *Geography, The Media and Popular Culture*. Kent, 192-228.
- BURGESS, J. (1990): The production and consumption of environmental meanings in the mass media: a research agenda for the 1990s. *Transactions of the Institute of British Geographers* 15 (2), 139-161.
- CORRIGAN, T. (1991): *A Cinema Without Walls: Movies and Culture After Vietnam*. New Brunswick.
- COSGROVE, D. (1994): Postmodern Tremblings: A Reply to Michael Dear. *Annals of the Association of American Geographers* 84, 305-307.
- DALBY, S. (1994): Gender and critical geopolitics: reading security discourse in the new world disorder. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 12, 595-612.
- DANIELS, S. (1989): Marxism, culture and the duplicity of landscape. PEET, R. and N. THIRIFT (Eds.): *New Models in Geography*. London, 196-220.
- DE CERTEAU, M. (1984): *The Practice of Everyday Life*. Berkeley.
- DE LAURETIS, T. (1984): *Alice Doesn't: Feminism, Semiotics and Cinema*. Bloomington.
- DEAR, M. (1994): Who's Afraid of Postmodernism?: Reflections on Symanski and Cosgrove. *Annals of the Association of American Geographers* 84, 295-300.
- DEMISEY, M. (1989): Quatsi Means Life: The Films of Godfrey Reggio. *Film Quarterly* 42, 2-12.
- DER DERIAN, J. (1992): *Anti-Diplomacy: Spies, Terror, Speed and War*. Oxford.
- DERRIDA, J. (1978a): *Positions*. London.
- DERRIDA, J. (1978b): *Of Grammatology*. Baltimore.
- DEUTSCHE, R. (1990): Men in Space. *Strategies* 3, 130-137.
- DEUTSCHE, R. (1991): Boys Town. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 9, 5-30.

- DIXON, D. and J.P. JONES (1996): For a Supercalifragilisticexpialidocious Scientific Geography. *Annals of the Association of American Geographers* 86, 767-779.
- DOEL, M. (1993): Proverbs for paranoids: writing geography on hollowed ground. *Transactions of the Institute of British Geographers* 18 (3), 377-394.
- DOEL, M. and D. CLARKE (1996): *A night at the movies: the virtual, psychoanalysis, and everyday life*. Paper presented at the Institute of British Geographers Annual Conference, University of Strathclyde in Glasgow, January.
- ECO, U. (1979): *The Role of the Reader: Explorations in the Semiotics of Texts*. Bloomington.
- FOLCH-SERRA, M. (1990): Place, Voice and Space: Mikhail Bakhtin's Dialogical Landscape. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 8, 255-274.
- FOUCAULT, M. (1980): *Power / Knowledge*. New York.
- GAINES, J. (1988): White Privilege and Looking Relations: Race and Gender in Feminist Film theory. *Screen* 29 (4), 12-27.
- GAMMAN, L. and M. MARSHMENT (1989): *The Female Gaze: Women as Viewers of Popular Culture*. Seattle.
- GODFREY, B.J. (1993): Regional Depiction in Contemporary Film. *The Geographical Review* 83 (4), 428-440.
- GOLD, J.R. (1985): From Metropolis to The City: Film Visions of the Future City, 1919-39. BURGESS, J. and J.R. GOLD (Eds.): *Geography, The Media and Popular Culture*. Kent, 123-143.
- GREGORY, D. (1994): *Geographical Imaginations*. London.
- HANNA, S.P. (1996): Is it Roslyn or is it Cicely? Representation and the Ambiguity of Place. *Urban Geography* 17, 633-649.
- HARVEY, D. (1989): *The Condition of Postmodernity*. London.
- HARVEY, D. (1992): Postmodern morality plays. *Antipode* 24 (4), 300-326.
- HARVEY, D. (1993): From space to place and back again: Reflections on the condition of postmodernity. BIRD, J et al. (Eds.): *Mapping the Futures: Local Cultures, Global Change*. London, New York, 2-29.
- HORKHEIMER, M. and T.W. ADORNO (1973): *Dialectic of the Enlightenment*. London.
- HOPKINS, J. (1994): Mapping of Cinematic Places: Icons, Ideology, and the Power of (Mis)representation. AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (Eds.): *Place, Power, Situation and Spectacle*. Savage, Maryland, 47-65.
- JAMESON, F.R. (1981): *The Political Unconscious: Narrative as a Socially Symbolic Act*. Ithaca.
- JAMESON, F.R. (1992): *Signatures of the Visible*. New York.
- JAMESON, F.R. (1993): Postmodernism, or the cultural logic of late capitalism. DOCHERTY, T. (Ed.): *Postmodernism: A Reader*. New York, 312-332.
- JAMESON, F.R. (1995): *The GeoPolitical Aesthetic: Cinema and Space in the World System*. Indiana.
- JONES, J.P. (1995): Making geography objectively: occularity, representation and The Nature of Geography. NATTER, W., T. SCHATZKI and J.P. JONES (Eds.): *Objectivity and its Other*. New York.
- JONES, J.P., W. NATTER and T. SCHATZKI (Eds.) (1993): *Beyond Modernity? Postmodernism, Politics and Space*. New York.
- KIAK, T. (1994): Havana and Kingston: mass media images and empirical observations of two Caribbean cities in crisis. *Urban Geography* 15 (4), 318-344.
- KRIM, A. (1994): Filming Route 66: Documenting the Dust Bowl Highway. AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (Eds.): *Place, Power, Situation and Spectacle*. Savage, Maryland.
- KUHN, A. (1982): *Women's Pictures: Feminism and Cinema*. London.
- KUHN, A. (1985): *Power of the Image: Essays on Representation and Sexuality*. New York.
- KUHN, A. (Ed.) (1990): *Women in Film: an International Guide*. New York.
- MACDONALD, G.M. (1994): Third Cinema and the Third World. AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (Eds.): *Place, Power, Situation and Spectacle*. Savage, Maryland, 27-46.
- MANVELL, R. (1956): Geography and the Documentary Film. *The Geographical Magazine* 29, 417-422.

- MARCUSE, H. (1972): *Counter-Revolution and Revolt*. Boston.
- MASSEY, D. (1991): Flexible Sexism. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 9, 31–57.
- MULVEY, L. (1975): Visual Pleasure and Narrative Cinema. *Screen* 16 (3), 6–18.
- MULVEY, L. (1981): Afterthoughts on 'Visual Pleasure and Narrative Cinema' inspired by *Duel in the Sun*. *Framework* 6, 12–15.
- NATTER, W. (1994): The City as Cinematic Space: Modernism and Place in Berlin, *Symphony of a City*. AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (Eds.): *Place, Power, Situation and Spectacle*. Boston, 203–228.
- NATTER, W. and J.P. JONES (1993): Pets or Meat: Class, Ideology and Space in Roger and Me. *Antipode* 25 (2), 140–158.
- NICHOLSON, D. (1991): Images of Reality. *The Geographical Magazine* 63 (4), 28–32.
- Ó'TUATHAIL, G. (1993): The Effacement of Place? US Foreign Policy and the Spatiality of the Gulf. *Antipode* 25, 4–31.
- Ó'TUATHAIL, G. (1994): (Dis)placing geopolitics: writing on the maps of global politics. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 12, 525–546.
- PHILO, C. (1992): Foucault's Geography. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space* 10, 137–161.
- PILE, S. (1993): Human Agency and Human Geography Revisited: A Critique of "New Models". *Transactions of the Institute of British Geographers* 18 (1), 122–139.
- ROSE, G. (1994): The Cultural Politics of Place: Local Representations and Oppositional Discourse in Two Films. *Transactions of the Institute of British Geographers* 19 (1), 46–60.
- SHAPIRO, M.J. (1992): *Reading the postmodern polity: political theory as textual practice*. Minneapolis.
- SHARPE, J.P. (1993): Publishing American Identity: popular geopolitics, myth and the Readers Digest. *Political Geography* 12, 491–503.
- SMITH, J. (1996): Geographical Rhetoric: Modes and Tropes of Appeal. *Annals of the Association of American Geographers* 86 (1), 1–23.
- SOJA, E. (1989): *Postmodern Geographies: The Reassertion of Space in the Social Sciences*. London.
- SOJA, E. (1991): Heterotopologies: A Remembrance of Other Spaces in the Citadel-LA. *Strategies* 3, 6–39.
- SPIVAK, G. (1988): *In Other Worlds: Essays in Cultural Politics*. New York.
- STACEY, J. (1993): Textual Obsessions: methodology, history and researching female spectatorship. *Screen* 34 (3): 260–274.
- STAM, R. (1992): Mobilizing fictions: the Gulf War, the media and the recruitment of the spectator. *Public Culture* 4, 101–126.
- WRIGHT, B. (1956): Geography and the Documentary film: Britain, since 1945. *The Geographical Magazine* 29, 586–595.
- ZONN, L.E. (1984): Images of Place: A Geography of the Media. *Proceedings of the Royal Geographical Society of Australia* 84, 35–45.
- ZONN, L.E. and S.C. AITKEN (1994): Of Pelicans and Men: Symbolic Landscapes, Gender, and Australia's Storm Boy. AITKEN, S.C. and L.E. ZONN (Eds.): *Place, Power, Situation and Spectacle*. Boston, 137–159.

Marcus A. Doel

FROM ANIMATED PHOTOGRAPHY TO FILM:
THE FORMATION OF VERNACULAR RELATIVITY
IN EARLY ENGLISH FILMS (1895–1908)

*The essence of a thing
never appears at the outset,
but in the middle...*

(DELEUZE 1986, 3).

INTRODUCTION

*[E]arly cinema –
an all but lost continent
of invention and discovery*

(CHRISTIE 1994, 8).

The relationship between geography and film is gradually becoming an established area of research (e.g. AITKEN and ZONN 1994; CRESSWELL and DIXON 2002; LUKINBEAL and ZONN 2004). While this research embraces a very wide range of interests (social, cultural, economic, political, ecological, etc.), special emphasis has been placed on understanding how fiction and nonfiction films have represented different kinds of places, and in so doing fostered certain senses of place and particular kinds of identities (local, regional, and national; individual, inter-subjective, and collective; gendered, racialized, and sexualized; etc). Work on the 'cinematic city' is exemplary in this regard (e.g. BARBER 2002; BRUNO 1993; CHARNEY and SCHWARTZ 1995; CLARKE 1997; SHIEL and FITZMAURICE 2003). Although there has been burgeoning research into the geographical *content* of films, much less attention has been paid by Geographers to the *medium* of film itself (although, see CLARKE and DOEL 2005; DOEL 1999; DOEL and CLARKE 2002). This is a significant omission for three reasons. First, form structures content (DELEUZE 2004). Second, form always has a particular spatiality and temporality. Finally, researchers need to appreciate the specificity of film as a socio-technical medium. It has an historical geography that is distinct from the historical geographies of other media (cf. LATOUR and WEIBEL 2002).

Accordingly, this chapter is concerned with film *qua* film. It engages with the form rather than the content of film, and, in particular, those crucially important formative years at the end of the nineteenth century and start of the twentieth (c. 1895 to 1908) when 'animated photography' underwent a profound transformation,

into what we would recognize as 'film.' What became of animated photography, however, was not inevitable. The transformation was subject to contingency rather than necessity; a result of aleatory encounters rather than teleological determination (cf. DOEL 2004). This has led some film historians to suggest that there is a fundamental difference in kind, rather than a mere difference of degree, between the earliest films and those that came later (e.g. BURCH 1990; ELSAESSER and BARKER 1999; EZRA 2000). Here, I want to account for this difference using the case of early English film.¹ England was especially important in the early years of animated photography because it had a sophisticated visual culture that was exceedingly well catered for by photographic equipment manufacturers, accomplished photographers and magic-lanternists, film pioneers, and trade journals.² Primary research for this chapter was undertaken at the British Film Institute and the National Film and Television Archive in London, and the Library of Congress in Washington D.C.

From the outset, it is worth underscoring the specificity of the very earliest films (c. 1895 to 1901). They were all extremely short (a minute or so) because of the unavailability of long lengths of film. With rare exceptions, staged films consisted of a tightly framed shot of a single scene using an immobile camera, frontal presentation, and histrionic acting. Effectively, filmmakers filmed a continuous take of a theatrical scene staged for the benefit of the camera – usually outdoors for maximum daylight. (As late as 1906, journals such as the *PLC* advertised cinematograph cameras as a "seasonal speciality." English filmmaking was concentrated in spring and summer, while exhibition accorded with the 'lantern season' of October to March.) The rare exceptions included 'panoramic films' taken from moving vehicles, usually trains, and the 'trick films' exemplified by Georges Méliès, which often used techniques drawn from stage magic, still photography, and lanternism (e.g. *Pepper's Ghost*, multiple exposure, and dissolves), although he is personally credited with inventing many cinematic techniques (e.g. substitution splicing and the close-up). One should think of early films as if they were music-hall turns, although their tight framing and two-dimensional composition tended to make them appear to be little more than self-contained, animated photographs. If the essence of film is to be found in the editing which is to say in the spatial and temporal relationship between that which is 'framed' and that which is 'out-of-field' (DELEUZE 1986; DELEUZE 1989), then the earliest results of animated photography were something other than film. The distinction between an animated *photograph* and an edited *film* is well illustrated by Mike FIGGIS in *Timecode* (2000): the screen is divided into four sections, each of which presents one of four continuous 93-minute takes filmed simultaneously.

1. USAI (1994) provides a helpful introduction to the difficulties involved in researching early film.

2. The following abbreviations for trade journals have been employed:

CBM = Cinematograph and Bioscope Magazine.

KLW = The Kinematograph and Lantern Weekly.

OLCJ = The Optical Lantern and Cinematograph Journal.

OLKJ = The Optical Lantern and Kinematograph Journal.

OMLJPE = The Optical Magic Lantern Journal and Photographic Enlarger.

OPTR = The Optician and Photographic Trades Review.

PLC = Projection, Lantern and Cinematograph.

WB = The Westminster Budget.

ANIMATED PHOTOGRAPHY: FILM BEFORE FILM

[W]hat can be done to stem
the already ebbing tide of popular favour[?]

(OMLPE, Vol. 8, No. 97, June 1897, 103).

It is often thought that the public *début* of the Lumière Cinématographe in 1895 in Paris, and 1896 in London, introduced audiences to an *absolute novelty*: 'living pictures.' Since time immemorial, virtually all forms of visual representation have been associated with unprecedented realism: paintings, camera obscuras, dioramas, panoramas, photographs, stereoscopes, etc. For example, an article in *Photographic Art Journal*, August 1853, characterized photography as a "solar pencil" able to "transcribe *exactly*." Animated photography reputedly offered something more than ultra-realism, however. For the images projected onto the screen were not simply *life-like*. They actually seemed to *be alive*. Little wonder, then, that contemporary trade journals, exhibitors, and the public referred to animated photography as 'living pictures,' although, once again, this phrase was widely associated with the camera obscura, the magic lantern, and photography (e.g. *The New Yorker*, 13th and 20th April 1839), and commentators were acutely aware of the fact that photographers needed technical competence, artistic skill, and an empathetic 'soul' to "give the semblance of *life*, instead of a mere *shadow* of life" (*Photographic Art Journal*, August 1853). The same distinction was applied to animated photographs (BURCH 1990). It is a distinction that subtends the *entire* history of Western representation's skiamachy.

The prefix 'bio-' (signifying life) was just as prevalent in the early years as that of 'ciné-' or 'kino-' (signifying movement). In the U.S. the Bioscope was the major competitor of the Lumière Cinématographe, and both came in the wake of the commercial success of Edison's peepshow Kinetoscope.³ Only gradually did the less emotive word 'film' come to supplant 'bio,' 'ciné,' and 'kino' as the preferred name for the medium as a whole. The word 'film' was initially reserved for the light-sensitive strip of material upon which the images were fixed; although, it quickly became synonymous with the images themselves and the medium in its totality. This conflation resulted in confusion about the object of early 'film' criticism. When the *OMLPE* (Vol. 8, No. 97, June 1897, 105) stated that "good films ... have been ... few and far between," Eastman Kodak insisted that its films were always of excellent quality.

The sense of absolute novelty occasioned by the advent of animated photography is best illustrated by what CHRISTIE (1994, 15) calls "*the* founding myth of cinema." This refers to reports of audiences panicking when they saw the

3. 'Bioscope' was originally a Registered Trade Mark for cinematographs manufactured by the Warwick Trading Co. The protection was subsequently withdrawn, however, when the High Court determined that the word was "more or less descriptive." The company lamented the fact that competitors rapidly appropriated the name: "Rotomotoscope, Vitaflashograph, Flickerlessoscope, Vivascope, and other words with the suffixes 'graph' and 'scope' were immediately changed to 'Bioscope'" (*CBM*, No. 4, July-September 1906, 63).

LUMIÈRES' *Arrivée d'un train en gare à La Ciotat*, which seemed "to dart out of the screen like an arrow," according to Maxime Gorki. Unfortunately, this affect is not borne out by documentary evidence (BOTTOMORE 1999). The mythical status of the panicking audience is well illustrated by the fact that it was parodied in films such as Robert W. PAUL's *The Countryman and the Cinematograph* (1901). One should also recall that roller-coasters and phantasmagoria had already made fear an amusing thrill long before the advent of film (CASTLE 1988; GUNNING 1995). Indeed, films found an early home in fairgrounds; and, one of the most commercially successful outlets for film before the U.S. nickelodeon boom of the late 1900s was the so-called "Hale's Tours" (a.k.a. 'phantom rides') of 1904–1907, which screened films taken from moving trains in a mocked-up railway carriage (FIELDING 1984; RABINOVITZ 1998). Hale's Tours came to England in 1906, and received great acclaim (*OLKJ*, Vol. 3, No. 3, January 1907, 78; *KLW*, Vol. 1, No. 3, 30 May 1907, 44).

The longevity of claims to ultra-realism and the mythical status of the 'train effect' suggest that the novelty of animated photography lay elsewhere. What appears to have amazed audiences was movement within the *detail* of the image (especially water, leaves, dust, and smoke), rather than the movement of the image per se, which was already an accomplished fact by the 1890s (see HECHT 1993). Yet again, it is worth noting that earlier visual technologies were associated with this quality. For example, in his diary entry for the 4th December 1839, Philip Hone described the Daguerreotype (the prototypical form of photography) thus: "Every object, however minute, is a perfect transcript of the thing itself; the hair of the human head, the gravel on the roadside, the texture of a silk curtain, or the shadow of the smaller leaf reflected upon the wall."⁴

Coming in the wake of a vast amount of experimentation that tried to perfect the reproduction of a moving image, what was being sought in the 1890s was an apparatus capable of recording and projecting a *continuous* strip of instantaneously exposed photographic images. While Louis Le Prince, William Friese Greene, Wordsworth Donisthorpe, and the Skladanowsky brothers all attempted to answer this call (in 1888, 1889, 1890, and 1892/4, respectively), the Lumière brothers' success in projecting their results – to critical acclaim in 1895 – appeared to assure them of the accolade. Such an accolade was far from assured, however, not least because of the tendency for critics to be incredulous about optical 'novelties.' This tendency is well illustrated by the derision heaped upon Thomas Edison's Kinetoscope when it was exhibited in London in 1894. One commentator suggested that it should "only be regarded as an amusing toy" owing to "the smallness of the pictures and the want of clearly defined light and shade, as well as by the inconvenience of looking down into the instrument" (*WB*, Vol. 4, No. 91, 26th October 1894, 754). Similarly, while the *KLW* recalled that in 1896, "people flocked in crowds" to the Empire Theatre, London, to see Lumière films, it remarks that the Alhambra Theatre, London, was also offered the Lumière show but "threw a cold blanket on the proposed enterprise" (*KLW*, No. 8, 4th July 1907, 125). In short, late nineteenth-century visual culture was not waiting expectantly for cinema to be born.

4. <http://www.iath.virginia.edu/fdw/volume3/werner/contexts4.html>. Accessed: 29.07.04.

Even though the Cinématographe managed to establish itself as an optical novelty suitable for a paying public (especially as part of music-hall variety programs), few imagined that animated photography would remain a popular attraction for long (the downfall of once incredibly popular visual attractions such as the stereoscope, Panorama, Praxinoscope, and X-rays provides an apt illustration of the fate that seemed to await even the most startling of optical novelties). Many feared that the medium would not survive the waning public interest in seeing yet another form of living pictures. BOTTOMORE (1996) reports evidence that in the first few years of the twentieth century film slipped down the order of attractions and disappeared entirely in some places. This fact is supported by contemporary trade journals. The *OMLPE* began to worry about waning public interest in film as early as 1897, just one year after the public début of the Cinématographe in England. "During the past year or so no novelty connected with optical projection has secured so much of the attention of the public as what are known as animated photographs. This attention has been due in no small measure to curiosity, and signs are not wanting that it has already begun to flag" (*OMLPE*, Vol. 8, No. 97, June 1897, 103). The article lists many failings of animated photography, including poor equipment, bad films, and incompetent exhibition. Indeed, as late as 1908, the *KLW* felt moved to promote cinematography by publishing a bumper international edition of the journal at the end of the lantern / film season. It called the issue its "Propaganda Summer Number" (*KLW*, Vol. 3, No. 60, 2nd July 1908).

AN UNTIMELY PROBLEM: 'TRUE MOTION'

Realism is the cry, and realism they must have

(*OMLPE*, Vol. 11, No. 131, April 1900, 48).

From the outset, then, the principle attraction of animated photography was tautological. The public wanted *animated* photography. Accordingly, one of the pioneers of early English film noted, "The films consisted in the old days of pictures of railway trains in cuttings and of omnibuses in Piccadilly – any little thing which tended to movement. ... Any form of movement satisfied us, because it was a miracle to see moving photographs, and that was what people were asking for" (HEPWORTH 1917, quoted in HERBERT 2000, xii). While many craved animation, those who were enamored by the tradition of landscape idealization and Romanticism deplored film's aesthetic consequences. For example, the Showman insisted, "[T]here is a want of beauty in animated photographs from the fact that they depend on the reproduction of street scenes and others in which moving objects predominate – simple landscape subjects being quite out of the question" (*OMLPE*, Vol. 8, No. 97, June 1897, 105).

What mattered to early film-makers, exhibitors, and audiences was the animation of animated photography. This fixation is starkly illustrated by the fallout from the 1906 decision of Pathé Frères to charge 4d. per foot for its films. Until then, films were typically priced according to the costs incurred (The global dominance of Pathé Frères was such that all other producers did likewise). Once they began to

pay for film by length, exhibitors became concerned that some footage did not contain suitably animated photographs. In particular, the *KLW* highlighted concerns about what it ironically called 'non-animated film.' Tellingly, "Chas. Lewis complains that in some films, after the action of handing a letter (in the scene) a great number of feet of film are used containing nothing but the repetition of this letter, the object being to enable the audience to read it. The part he objects to is that all this measurement is charged to him as so many feet, yet there is no action shown" (*KLW*, Vol. 3, No. 84, 17th December 1908, 823). The complainant suggests that rather than be charged for a contradiction in terms (non-animated film), the exhibitor should be supplied with a magic-lantern slide – the cost of which would be much cheaper. While this aversion to static images might seem like an overly literal concern, it is worth remembering that late nineteenth-century and early twentieth-century visual culture had no shortage of devices for reproducing static and moving images, especially the well-established, and increasingly sophisticated, magic lantern (BARBER 1993; COOK 1963). What everyone wanted from the Cinématographe was truly animated pictures. One of the most telling sales-pitches, in this regard, is the claim made by the Charles Urban Trading Co. that "all 'padding' is eliminated" from its films (Catalogue, February 1905, 6).

With the accent placed firmly on the animation of animated photography, trade journals focused their attention squarely on refining the moving image. Over and over again, advertisements for early films emphasized their animation (e.g. an 1897 advertisement for Robert W. Paul's "Animated photograph films" lists dozens of animated subjects, while an 1897 advertisement for Rigg's "Kinematograph" includes images of roundabouts, railway stations, tram termini, and children leaving school). And, what did the Lumière brothers' film in 1895/6? They filmed action: the *demolition* of a wall, workers *leaving* a factory, the *fluttering* of leaves, the *disembarking* of passengers, Jerusalem from a *moving* train, and, most famously of all, the *arrival* of a train.

Far from solving the problem of recording and projecting ultra-realistic and life-like animated photographs, however, the Cinématographe gave rise to all manner of optical oddities and technical difficulties. First and foremost, hand-cranking during filming and projection meant, that "[U]nless the projecting of the subject upon the lantern screen is conducted precisely at a speed corresponding to that at which the negative picture was taken, false representations of nature will result. Our beloved art becomes a cause for laughter when men march at a running speed; when artillery guns skate over the ground on carriages with stationary wheels; and when the wheels on the Royal carriage revolve backwards" (*OLCJ*, Vol. 1, November 1904, 11). Indeed, trade journals tried in vain for more than a decade to convince the film industry to adopt the more costly but 'flickerfree' rate of 24 frames per second as its standard, rather than the customary (but cost-effective) rate of 12 to 16 frames per second.

As well as fretting about flicker and the misrepresentation of natural movement, English trade journals were especially scathing of that "class of trickery" in which "the laws of nature are assumed to be set at variance" (e.g. unnatural camera angles, as in W. R. BOOTH's 1899 film *Upside Down*; or, *the Human Flies*; the splitting of

the screen, as in James WILLIAMSON's 1901 film *Are You There?*; speed magnification, as in Robert W. PAUL's 1906 film *How To Make Time Fly*); and, they deplored the use of lenses whose focal length gave "false perspective" and therefore "false motion" (*KLW*, Vol. 2, No. 35, 9th January 1908, 141–143). Consequently, journals declared that "the various illusions to which the art is subject" means that "it becomes a problem taxing the greatest genius, how best to avoid giving false effect upon the screen" (*OLCJ*, Vol. 1, November 1904, 11). As late as 1908, journals, such as the *KLW*, could still bemoan the fact that film-makers had only managed to effect a "continuity of impression," not "true motion" (*KLW*, Vol. 2, No. 37, 23rd January 1908, 179; cf. BERGSON's [1907] condemnation of the cinematic granulation of duration: time dried up as space). "[A]lmost every scene we witness furnishes subject matter for adverse criticism, insomuch as either optical or motional defects are sure to crop up" (*KLW*, Vol. 2, No. 35, 9th January 1908, 141).

The obsession with perfecting the reproduction of 'true motion' was unlikely to combat waning public interest in film during the 1900s. What ensured its continuing success after the initial novelty of animation wore off was arguably the public's appetite for comic subjects (which was begrudgingly acknowledged by most of the trade journals; although, that did not stop them from promoting more edifying, educational, and bourgeois subjects). This appetite was well catered for by filmmakers. Before the onset of news-reels and full-blown narrative films in the 1910s, the earliest films (c. 1895 to 1906) are best thought of as constituting a 'cinema of attractions' that gave audiences a form of visceral pleasure (BURCH 1990). Only very gradually did films depart from the structure of an animated *photograph*, a living *picture* or a moving *tableaux* (this is not to say that they were atemporal, only that time tended to be inscribed synchronically *within* the scene, rather than being fashioned diachronically *between* scenes through editing). As I noted at the outset of this paper, before 1903, nearly all of the 'fiction' films were very short (less than a minute or so) and consisted of a tightly framed shot of a planar scene using an immobile camera, frontal presentation, and histrionic acting. This is why they could be used interchangeably with other music-hall turns, since their staging accorded with the prevailing theatrical conventions. Indeed, such turns were frequently the subject of early films. The excavation of depth, formation of perspective, use of off-screen space, and linking of scenes were things that took years to develop. Contrary to what one might expect, these aspects were absolutely not inherent features of the medium (ABEL 1996; BOWSER 1990; BREWSTER and JACOBS 1997; BURCH 1990; ELSAESSER and BARKER 1990; LANT 1995; PEARSON 1992). It took decades for film-makers to fashion the kind of 'narrative space' governed by 'continuity editing' that became the bedrock of classic Hollywood cinema and so familiar to twentieth-century audiences (HEATH 1981).

The fixation of the trade journals on the need to refine a moving image was already anachronistic in the 1890s. Why? Because animated photography was not only widely anticipated, but effectively accomplished by the end of the 1880s. The sticking point was not animated pictures per se, but the difficulty of emancipating the moving images from the small loops, slide-sequences, and peep-boxes within which it had been ensnared, and projecting them onto a screen.

The nineteenth century gave rise to innumerable devices dedicated to the reproduction of moving images. The Thaumatrope, Phenakistiscope, Zoëtrope, and Praxinoscope are widely regarded as the most important precursors of film. For centuries, people had been aware that the images on either side of a spinning coin seemed to fuse into a single image. The spinning coin, or Thaumatrope ('wonder-turner'), was first commercialized as a visual attraction by John Paris in 1825. This was soon followed by the Phenakistiscope ('deceptive view') or stroboscope; invented independently in 1832 by Joseph Plateau and Simon Ritter von Stampfer. It consisted of a disc upon which a series of pictures representing the consecutive positions of a moving body were arranged radially. When the disc was spun, and the pictures viewed through a fixed slit, the images blended into continuous movement. The Zoëtrope ('wheel of life') or Daedelum, patented by William Horner in 1834, employed the same principle; although, the images were arranged on a paper band inside a slotted drum. In 1877, Emile Reynaud adapted the Zoëtrope by mounting mirrors on a central polygonal drum to produce his Praxinoscope ('action view'), thus dispensing with the need for slots, increasing the clarity of the image, and achieving 'optical stationarity' of the image (The absence of flicker led at least one commentator to suggest using cinematographic prints in a Praxinoscope: *OPTR*, 29th March 1901, 71). In 1882, Gaston Tissandier described, in *La nature*, a projection Praxinoscope, produced by Reynaud as a domestic entertainment. Reynaud belatedly developed a theatrical version – the *Théâtre Optique* – in 1889, and showed his first three strips in 1892, at the Musée Grévin in Paris. Although a great success, production of the strips was laborious: each image was a separate drawing that was transferred to gelatin and hand colored. Also in 1892, J. A. R. Rudge, the 'Wizard of the Magic Lantern,' experimented with various lantern adjuncts to create an impression of continuous and naturalistic movement using rotating galleries of photographic slides (e.g. facial grimaces). Other significant devices included the peep-box Filoscope, Kinora, and Mutoscope – each of which showed a sequence of photographic prints in rapid succession to cinematic effect (*OPTR*, 29th March 1901, 7172). However, perhaps the most accomplished apparatus for presenting a moving image was the theatrical stage set known as the 'Diorama' (not to be confused with the 'Panorama'). Dioramas positioned the spectator on a viewing platform at the centre of a 360° circular painting (of a landscape, battlefield, cityscape, etc.) that was housed in a purpose-built rotunda with false terrain and an interior roof – thus giving the spectator an impression of being totally immersed in a complete illusion (COMMENT 1999; OETTERMANN 1997; SCHIVELBUSCH 1988). BENJAMIN (1999, 529) described the Diorama as "a sportive precursor of fast-motion cinematography – a witty and somewhat malicious, 'dancing' acceleration of time."

The enormous Diorama stage sets were most famous for their transformation of day into night by the application of lighting effects onto a scene such as a landscape rendered in two different forms on either side of a translucent canvas. "Only two effects were actually painted on – day on the front of the canvas, night on the back, and one could only shift from one to the other by means of a series of complicated combinations of media the light had to pass through. But these produced an infinite

number of additional effects similar to those Nature offers in its course from morning to night and vice versa" (Daguerre, quoted in VIRILIO 1994, 41). This lighting technique was based on Jean Servandoni's *Spectacles de decoration* (c. 1738), Philippe-Jacques Lautherbourg's *Eidophusikon* (c. 1781), Franz König's *Diaphanorama* (c. 1811), and the well established tradition of light-boxes, peep-shows, and magic-lanterns.

Given the sophistication of nineteenth-century visual culture, animated photographs and living pictures were not actually that novel; and, they were certainly not startling enough to precipitate audience panic. The *Cinématographe* did not appear out of the blue. It brought together and refined a whole series of previous inventions, and was commercialized with reference to a paying public already well versed in the pleasures of disenchanted night (from light-boxes and peep-shows to phantasmagoria and roller-coasters). Likewise, as attractions, films were not necessarily that attractive. As late as 1907, the *KLW* was still lamenting the fact that "In the music hall programme the kinematograph is merely regarded as a turn instead of a separate entertainment.... 'American Bioscope' ranks on the equal to 'So and so, the comedian'" (*KLW*, No. 4, 6th June 1907, 59), while the *OLKJ* once again labored the virtues of those few music-hall managers who were "awakening to the fact that the kinematograph should be regarded as something more than a stop gap" between other entertainments (*OLKJ*, Vol. III, No. 5, March 1907, 115).

A TIMELY PROBLEM: VERNACULAR RELATIVITY

*The photograph ...
has a completely different ambition
than representing, illustrating, or narrating*

(DELEUZE 2003, 8-9).

Late nineteenth-century visual culture had little use for yet another form of 'moving picture.' Likewise, the trade journals' obsession with perfecting the ability of animated photography to represent 'true motion' rather than a mere 'continuity of impression' appeared at best anachronistic and at worst entirely misplaced. From the 1820s and 1830s, vision was de-naturalized and thoroughly grounded in artifice (CRARY 1990; STAFFORD 1994). Fortunately, something entirely unexpected was happening to animated photography that carried it away from the false problem of perfecting true motion: the advent of editing techniques. These were a radical departure from the techniques associated with other nineteenth-century optical devices (e.g. the ghostly multiple exposures of still photography, and the animation techniques of magic-lantern slides). For example, Georges Méliès claimed to have inadvertently invented stop-motion cinematography (*arrêt de caméra* or substitution splicing) when his camera jammed outside the Paris Opéra. The visual effect of stopping and then restarting his camera was to transform an omnibus into a hearse, and men into women. While stop-motion was especially associated with phantas-

magoric effects of appearance, transformation, and vanishing – which EZRA (2000) dubs ‘fantastic realism’ – it also gave rise to time-lapse cinematography. This method was famously employed in the 1902 Biograph film of the demolition of New York’s Star Theatre, where so-called “speed magnification” seemed to make the building melt into the ground in a matter of minutes. Time-lapse was used as early as 1897, when Birt Acres filmed clouds at about a frame per second, “thus exaggerating the movement but retaining the form” (Birt Acres 1897; quoted in BARNES 1983, 21).

‘Stop-motion,’ ‘speed magnification,’ and a host of other editing techniques suggested an alternative future for animated photography. Hereinafter, editing would enable the Cinématographe to stop slavishly re-presenting an actual or staged instant, and to start functioning as an apparatus that could both manipulate and manufacture space and time. In so doing, animated photography ceased being a *referential* medium, bound to the Real, to become a *simulacral* medium, free to fabricate a reality-effect (BAUDRILLARD 1994; DELEUZE 1994). The word that captured the new potential of film was ‘montage’ a word drawn from the surreal world of paper-play. Modernity had set the “laws of nature at variance;” and, through editing, film became the quintessential medium for making this variance visible. Each frame (image) refers to that which is out-of-frame; but, this latter is necessarily two-fold. On the one hand, the frame refers to what is around the frame – a spatially and temporally contiguous ‘unseen’ that may, in its turn, subsequently enter the frame and so become actualized as a scene / scene. On the other hand, the frame also refers to the absolute proximity of non-contiguous spaces and times – a manifold ‘unseen’ that can never be actualized as a framed seen / scene, but which nevertheless is pullulated and ramified to infinity (DELEUZE 1986; cf. the two-fold cinematic ‘gesture’ in AGAMBEN 2000). The essential thing about film, then, is not the framed image, but that which comes *between* the frames: *the cut* (cf. DELEUZE 1990; DELEUZE 1994). In the first two decades of film exhibition, the main scourge of animated photography, according to trade journals, was neither the failure to render ‘true motion’ nor waning public interest in ‘living pictures.’ The main scourge was *flicker* – the trace of the cut par excellence. The war against flicker was won when filmmakers eventually adopted the rate of 24 frames per second in the late 1900s. It was only with the advent of continuity editing and narrative cinema, however, that the out-of-frame was finally tamed. Thereafter, the explosive potential of the out-of-frame is barely felt beyond the narrow confines of avant-garde filmmaking.

Editing enabled film to express what CHRISTIE (1994, 33) aptly calls “vernacular relativity.” Yet, given the initial fixation of the medium on animating a *still* photograph and reproducing *true* motion, it should be clear why it was not certain that film would come to reproduce the “mechanization, jerkiness, and rush of modern times,” or, that it would end up heightening the “public consciousness of differential speed” (KERN 1983, 117 and 130, respectively). Similarly, it was not inevitable that “The compacting of events in time was best suited for the new art form of the period – the cinema” (KERN 1983, 279). Nor was it self-evident that film would expand “the sense of the present” by allowing one “to splice open a moment

and insert a number of simultaneous activities" (KERN 1983, 70 and 71, respectively); and, in so doing, become a critical, explosive, and potentially revolutionary medium that would need to be muffled by the formation of continuity editing and narrative space (MCCOLE 1993).⁵ Indeed, rather than acknowledge this explosive potential, trade journals preferred to advocate the pulling power of so-called "local" or "see yourselves" films, which accords with the enthusiasm in the 1890s for the novelty of full-length "look at-yourself" mirrors in department stores.

Let me end with a powerful example of the wide-spread inability of contemporary commentators to conceive of animated photography as a space and time machine. In February 1897, the *OMLJPE* (Vol. 8, No. 93, February 1897, 39) published a reader's letter and its own humorous reply.

DEAR SIR, – Might it not be of interest to the temperance cause, by means of quick exposures and the cinematograph, to publish a roll of pictures showing the effect of alcohol upon the system by starting with a person perfectly sober, and plying him with drink until he becomes incapable, meantime taking pictures all the time so as to show the results until the patient, in common parlance, 'falls under the table.' ... If you know of any such set of slides, will you kindly let me know where I can obtain such, as I would then at once purchase one of the cinematographic apparatus, and include this subject in a series of lectures. Yours, etc., BARTOS.

Seeing that many exposures are made per second, and that the effects of which 'Bartos' speaks would take some considerable time, it is likely that a film to embrace this subject would have to be several miles long. As a film about 70 feet long costs a few pounds, we wonder if 'Bartos' would have sufficient ready cash to purchase one of the desired length, say twenty miles for £7,000 pounds. – ED.

Two months later, the journal republished a rejoinder that appeared in the *Alliance News*: "The editor is too humorous in his reply, and Bartos too wholesale in his suggestion to be practical. Photographs of a tippler gradually 'getting forrarder' taken at quarter hour intervals, would answer every purpose of instructive illustration" (*OMLJPE*, Vol. 8, No. 95, April 1897, 62). What is striking is that none of those involved in this exchange could envisage anything other than the continuity of real-time and the reciprocity of still photography and animated photography. The late nineteenth century witnessed the advent of film but not in the *form* that we have come to know it. Only the *flinker* testified to the cuts that were coming.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The research was undertaken in conjunction with Dr David CLARKE. The paper was presented to The Geography of Cinema: A Cinematic World symposium held at Johannes Gutenberg-University, Mainz, Germany, June 2004. I am grateful to Prof. Dr Anton Escher and Stefan Zimmermann for organizing this event, and to the

5. To the consternation of countless critics, one of the pioneers of continuity editing, Cecil HEPWORTH, famously renounced it: "Only the direst need will form an excuse for lifting an audience up by the scruff of the neck and carrying it round to the other side, just because you suddenly want to photograph something from the south when the previous scene has been taken from the north" (HEPWORTH 1951, 139).

participants for their comments. I would also like to thank the British Film Institute, the National Film & Television Archive, the Library of Congress, and the Arts & Humanities Research Board (Award No. B/SG/AN2054/APN10258).

REFERENCES

- ABEL, R. (Ed.) (1996): *Silent Film*. London.
- AGAMBEN, G. (2000): *Means Without End: Notes on Politics*. London.
- AITKEN, S. and L. ZONN (Eds.) (1994): *Place, Power, Situation and Spectacle: A Geography of Film*. Totowa.
- BARBER, S. (2002): *Projected Cities*. London.
- BARBER, X. T. (1993): The roots of travel cinema: John L. Stoddard, E. Burton Holmes and the nineteenth-century illustrated travel lecture. *Film History* 5 (1), 68–84.
- BARNES, J. (1983): *The Rise of the Cinema in Gt. Britain: The Beginnings of the Cinema in England 1894–1901. Volume 2: Jubilee Year 1897*. London.
- BAUDRILLARD, J. (1994): *Simulacra and Simulation*. Ann Arbor.
- BENJAMIN, W. (1999): *The Arcades Project*. Cambridge.
- BERGSON, H. (1907): *L'Evolution créatrice*. Paris.
- BOTTOMORE, S. (1996): "Nine days' wonder": early cinema and its sceptics. WILLIAMS, C. (Ed.): *Cinema. The Beginnings and the Future: Essays Marking the Centenary of the First Film Show Projected to a Paying Audience in Britain*. London, 135–149.
- BOTTOMORE, S. (1999): The panicking audience? Early cinema and the 'train effect'. *Historical Journal of Film, Radio & Television* 19, 177–216.
- BOWSER, E. (1990): *The Transformation of Cinema, 1907–1915*. Berkeley.
- BREWSTER, B. and L. JACOBS (1997): *Theatre to Cinema: Stage Pictorialism and the Early Feature Film*. Oxford.
- BRUNO, G. (1993): *Streetwalking on a Ruined Map: Cultural Theory and the City Films of Elvira Notari*. Princeton.
- BURCH, N. (1990): *Life to those Shadows*. London.
- CASTLE, T. (1988): Phantasmagoria: spectral technology and the metaphors of modern reverie. *Critical Inquiry* 15, 26–61.
- CHARNEY, L. and V. SCHWARTZ (Eds.) (1995): *Cinema and the Invention of Modern Life*. Berkeley.
- CHRISTIE, I. (1994): *The Last Machine: Early Cinema and the Birth of the Modern World*. London.
- CLARKE, D. B. (Ed.) (1997): *The Cinematic City*. London.
- CLARKE, D. B. and M. A. DOEL (2005): Engineering space and time: moving pictures and motionless trips. *Journal of Historical Geography* 31 (1), 41–60.
- COMMENT, B. (1999): *The Panorama*. London.
- COOK, O. (1963): *Movement in Two Dimensions: A Study of the Animated and Projected Pictures Which Preceded the Invention of Cinematography*. London.
- CRARY, J. (1990): *Techniques of the Observer: On Vision and Modernity in the Nineteenth Century*. Cambridge.
- CRESSWELL, T. and D. DIXON (Eds.) (2002): *Engaging Film: Geographies of Mobility and Identity*. Lanham.
- DELEUZE, G. (1986): *Cinema 1: The Movement-image*. London.
- DELEUZE, G. (1989): *Cinema 2: The Time-image*. London.
- DELEUZE, G. (1990): *The Logic of Sense*. London.
- DELEUZE, G. (1994): *Difference and Repetition*. London.
- DELEUZE, G. (2003): *Francis Bacon: The Logic of Sensation*. London.
- DELEUZE, G. (2004): *Desert Islands and Other Texts: 1953–1974*. New York.

- DOEL, M. A. (1999): Occult Hollywood: unfolding the Americanization of world cinema. SLATER, D. and P. J. TAYLOR (Eds.): *The American Century: Consensus and Coercion in the Projection of American Power*. London, 243–260.
- DOEL, M. A. (2004): Poststructuralist geographies: the essential selection. CLOKE, P., P. CRANG and M. GOODWIN (Eds.): *Envisioning Human Geography*. London, 146–177.
- DOEL, M. A. and D. B. CLARKE (2002): An invention without a future, a solution without a problem: motor pirates, time machines, and drunkenness on the screen. KITCHIN, R. and KNEALE, J. (Eds.): *Lost in Space: Geographies of Science Fiction*. London, 136–155.
- ELSAESSER, T. and A. BARKER (Eds.) (1990): *Early Cinema: Space, Frame, Narrative*. London.
- EZRA, E. (2000): *Georges Méliès: The Birth of the Auteur*. Manchester.
- FIELDING, R. (1984): Hale's Tours: ultrarealism in the pre-1910 motion picture. FELL, J. (Ed.): *Film Before Griffith*. Berkeley, 116–130.
- GUNNING, T. (1995): An aesthetic of astonishment: early film and the (in)credulous spectator. WILLIAMS, L. (Ed.): *Viewing Positions: Ways of Seeing Film*. Piscataway, New Jersey.
- HEATH, S. (1981): *Questions of Cinema*. Bloomington.
- HECHT, H. (1993): *Pre-Cinema History: An Encyclopaedia and Annotated Bibliography of the Moving Image Before 1896*, ed. A. HECHT. London.
- HEPWORTH, C. M. (1951): *Came the Dawn*. London.
- HERBERT, S. (Ed.) (2000): *A History of Early Film*. 3 Volumes. London.
- KERN, S. (1983): *The Culture of Time and Space: 1880–1918*. Cambridge.
- LANT, A. (1995): Haptical cinema. *October* 74, 45–73.
- LATOUR, B. and P. WEIBEL (Eds.) (2002): *Iconoclasm: Beyond the Image Wars in Science, Religion, and Art*. Cambridge.
- LUKINBEAL, C. and L. ZONN (Eds.) (2004): Theme issue: cinematic geographies. *GeoJournal* 59 (4), 247–333.
- MCCOLE, J. (1993): *Walter Benjamin and the Antinomies of Tradition*. London.
- OETTERMANN, S. (1997): *The Panorama: History of a Mass Medium*. New York.
- PEARSON, R. E. (1992): *Eloquent Gestures: The Transformation of Performance Style in the Griffith and Biograph Films*. Berkeley.
- RABINOVITZ, L. (1998): From Hale's Tours to Star Tours: virtual voyages and the delirium of the hyperreal. *Iris* 25, 133–152.
- SCHIVELBUSCH, W. (1988): *Disenchanted Night: The Industrialisation of Light in the Nineteenth Century*. Oxford.
- SHIEL, M. and T. FITZMAURICE (Eds.) (2003): *Screening the City*. London.
- STAFFORD, B. M. (1994): *Artful Science: Enlightenment Entertainment and the Eclipse of Visual Education*. Cambridge.
- USAI, P. (1994): *Burning Passions: An Introduction to the Study of Silent Cinema*. London.
- VIRILIO, P. (1994): *The Vision Machine*. London.